

**MECHANICAL PROPERTIES  
OF MATERIALS:  
Fundamentals, elastic and plastic  
behaviour**

# Mechanical properties of materials

- Materials choice
- Design issues
- Correlation requested properties/class of material
  
- Mechanical **properties independent of time**
- Mechanical **properties dependent on time**
- Mechanical **properties dependent on temperature**

$\sigma$  (**STRESS**) and  $\varepsilon$  (**STRAIN**) : definition

$\sigma$  (**STRESS**) = **F** (force, Newton, N) / **A** (surface, m<sup>2</sup>)  
 $\sigma = F/A$  (N/m<sup>2</sup> = Pa) (**N/mm<sup>2</sup> = MPa**)

**DEFORMATION or STRAIN:**

(dimensionless or %)

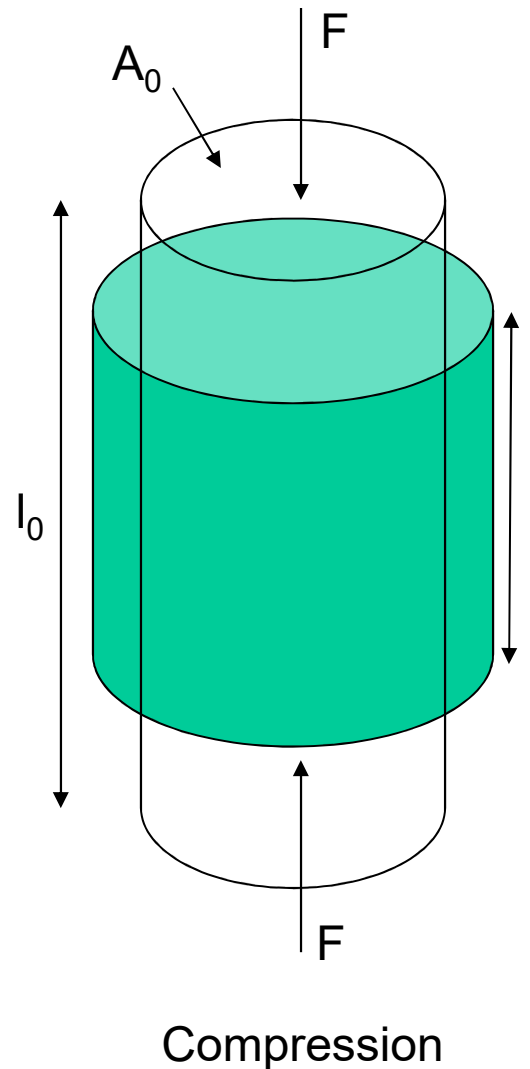
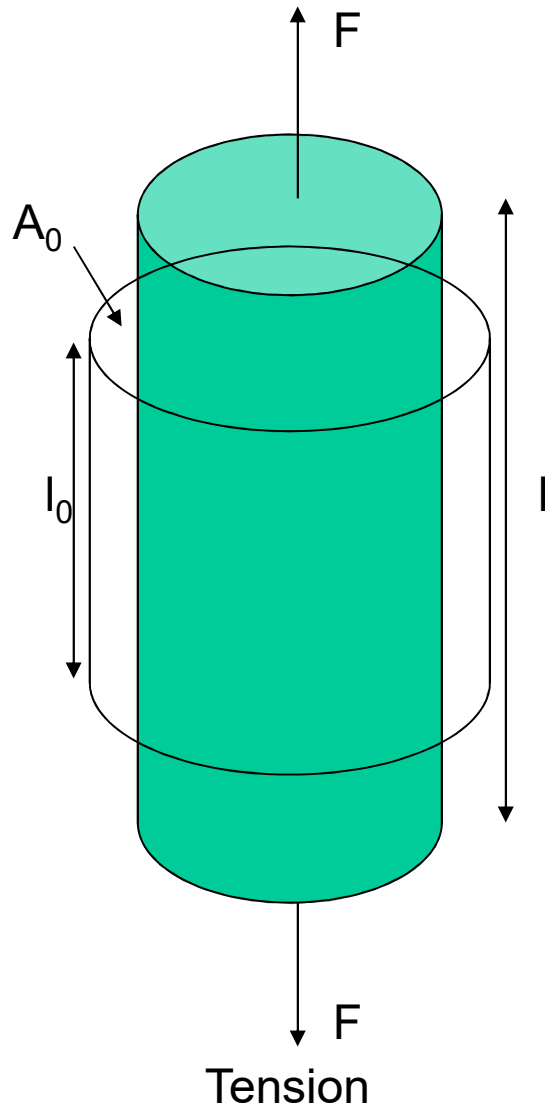
$$\varepsilon = (l - l_0)/l_0 = \Delta l/l_0$$

sample length =  $l$

initial sample length =  $l_0$

tensile stress, compressive stress, bending stress, shear stress

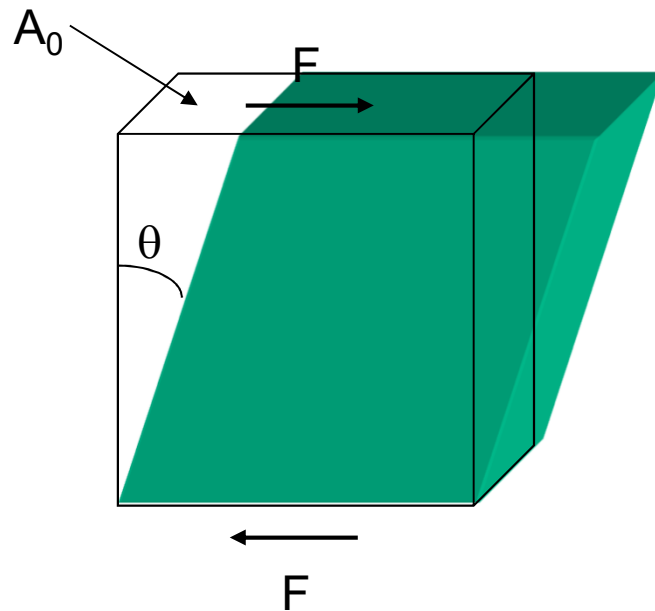
# Tensile and compression stress/strain



**Stress,  $\sigma = F/A_0$**

**Strain,  $\varepsilon = (l - l_0)/l_0$   
 $= \Delta l/l_0$**

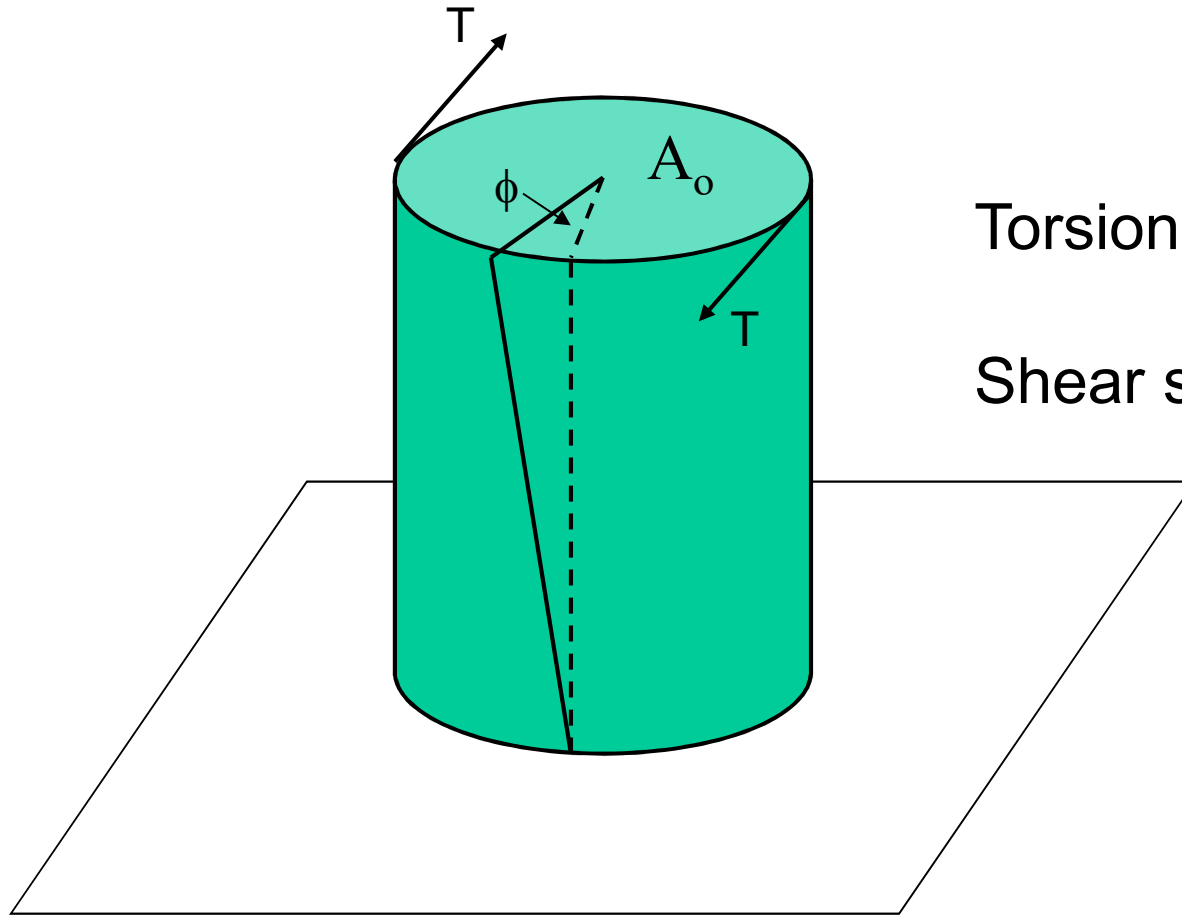
# Shear



(Shear stress),  $\tau = F/A_0$

(Shear strain),  $\gamma = \tan \theta$

# Torsion

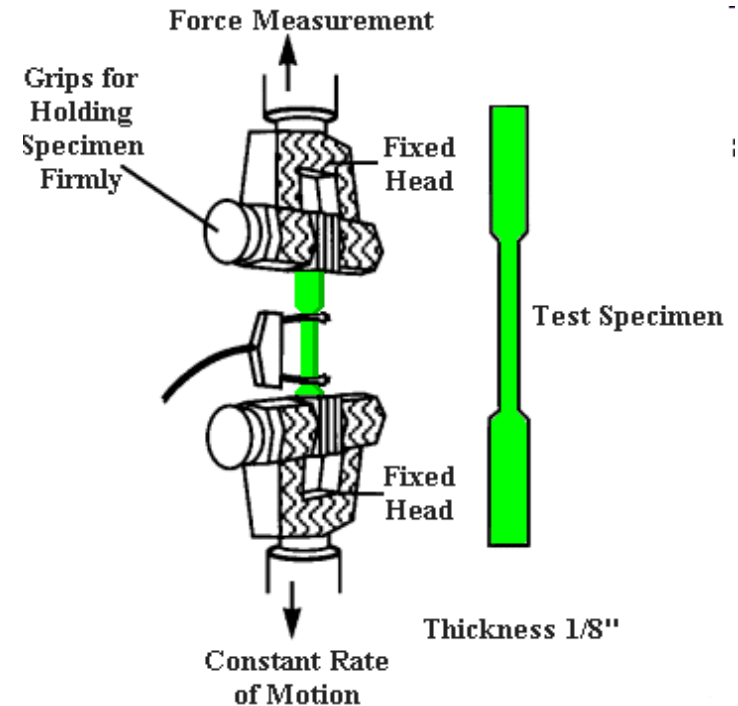
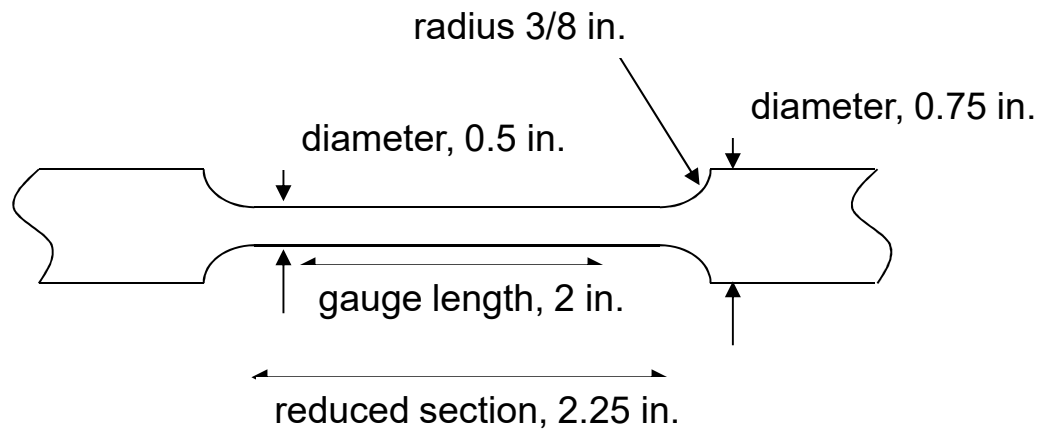


Torsion  $\tau = T/A_o$

Shear strain,  $\gamma = \tan \phi$

# Stress-strain curves (tensile test)

- Standard tests!

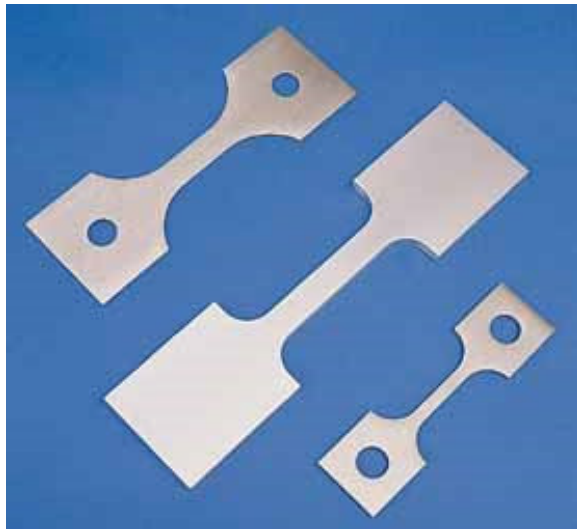
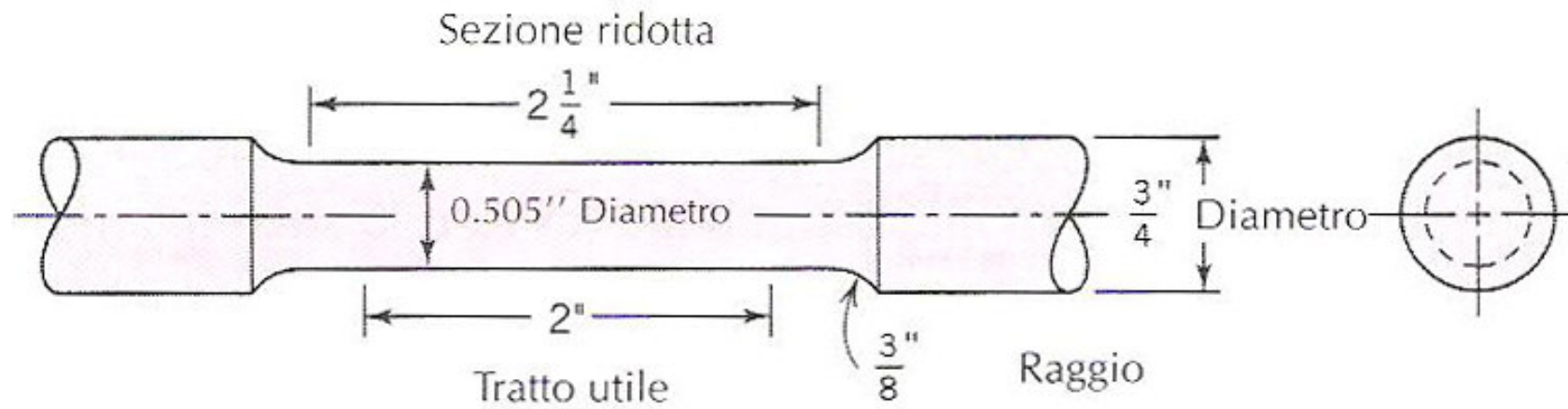


ASTM (American Society for Testing and Materials)

ISO

UNI EN

*Standard circular cross-section for tensile tests*



*Metallic  
specimens*



**For most of materials, low stresses correspond to proportionally low deformations (direct proportionality)**

$\sigma = E \varepsilon$  (Hooke law, E=Young modulus or elastic modulus)

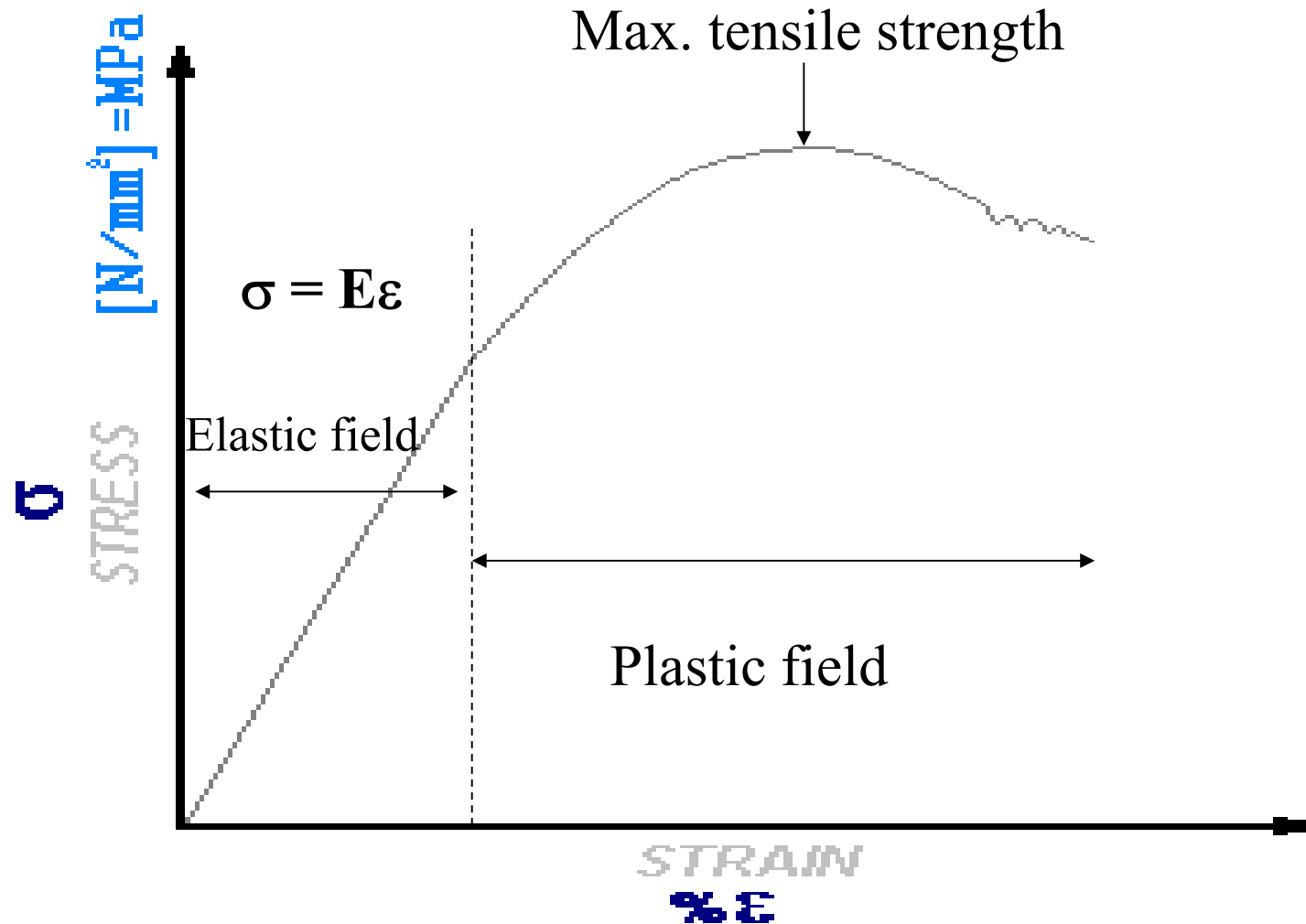
$$\sigma = F/A$$

$$\varepsilon = \Delta l/l_0$$

$$[E] = \text{MPa or GPa}$$

$$F/A = E \Delta l/l_0$$

# Tensile test curve on a metal



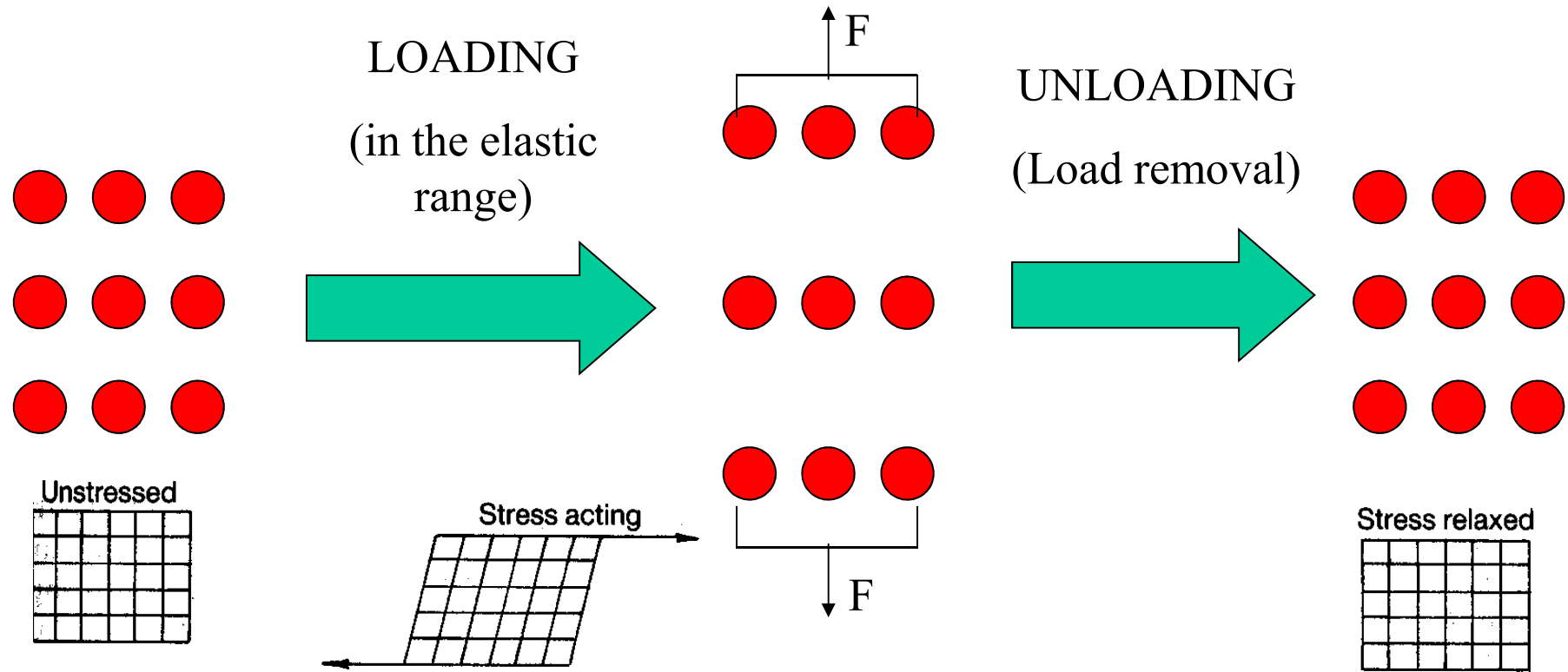
# Elastic behaviour

- Small **stress** corresponds to small **deformation** having a **direct proportionality** between them.
- Small deformations are **immediately recovered** when stress is removed
- **$E = \sigma / \varepsilon = [\text{N/mm}^2] = [\text{MPa}]$**

Young's modulus or Elastic Modulus **E**  
(Hooke law)

# Elastic modulus and atomic bond

- $E_{\text{ceramics}} > E_{\text{metals}} \gg E_{\text{polymers}}$
- Elastic modulus is directly proportional to the energy of the atomic bond (and melting temperature)
- No fracture of bonds in the elastic field
- Increasing of the bond length when stress is applied.
- Immediate recovering of the bond equilibrium length after stress removal



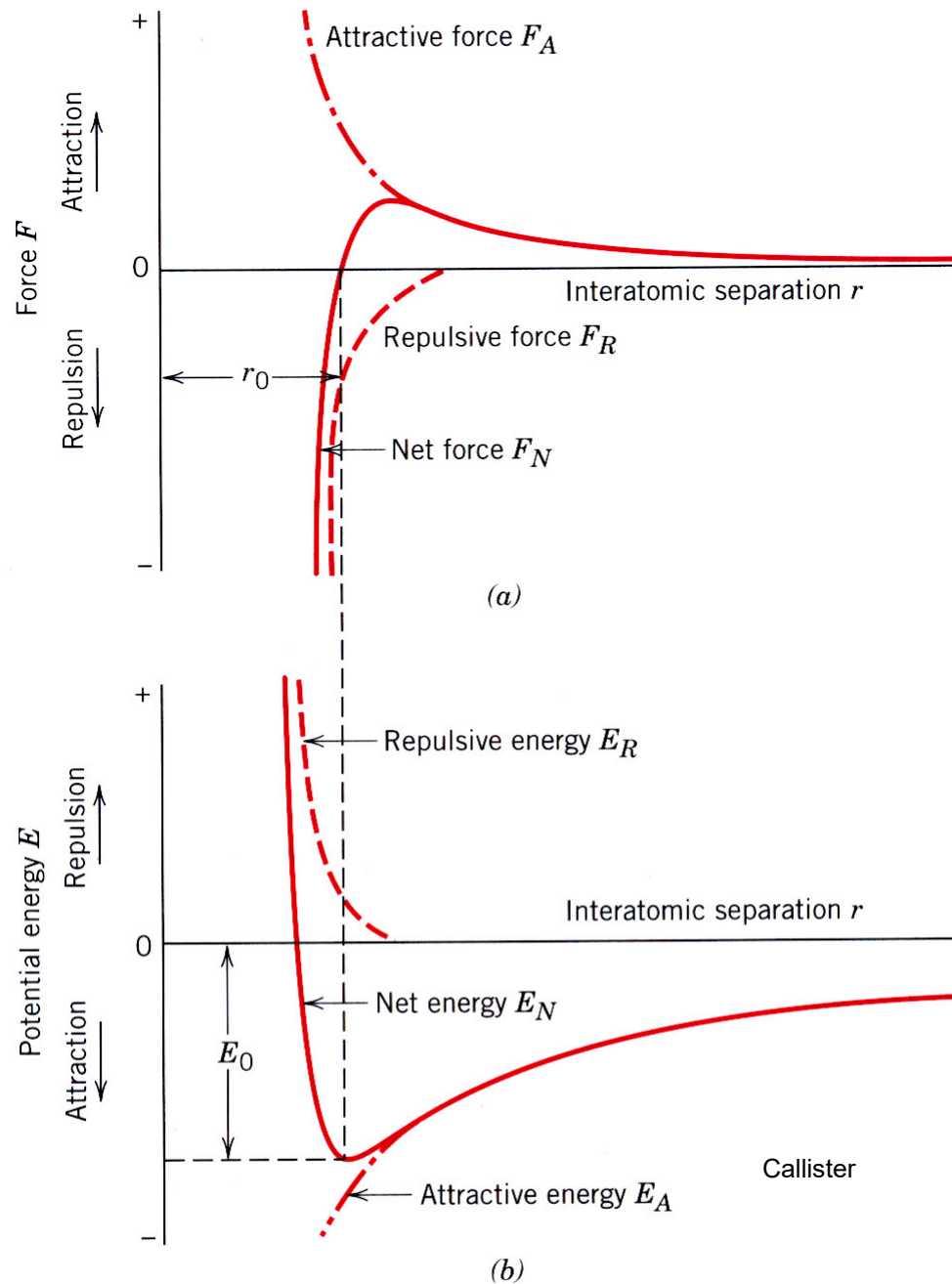
EQUILIBRIUM STATE  
NO APPLIED LOAD  
THE DISTANCE  
BETWEEN ATOMS IS  
THAT OF THE STABLE  
CHEMICAL BOND

DURING ELASTIC  
DEFORMATION THE  
BONDS BECOME  
LONGER IN THE  
DIRECTION OF LOAD  
APPLICATION

(much longer as weaker the  
bonds are)

WHEN THE  
LOAD IS  
REMOVED THE  
ATOMS COME  
BACK TO THEIR  
EQUILIBRIUM  
DISTANCE

## Condon-Morse curves



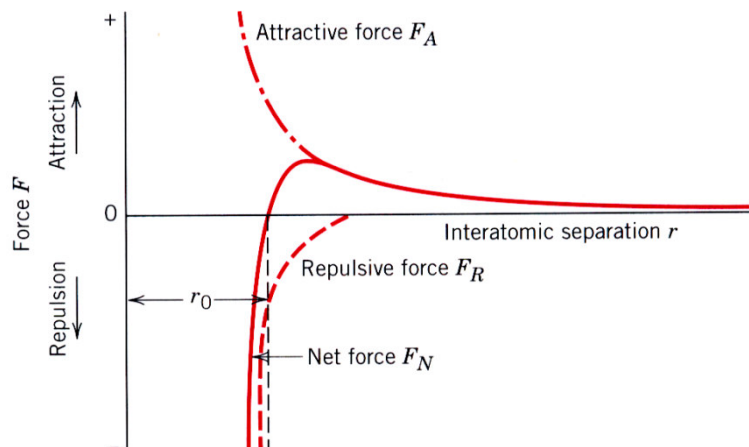
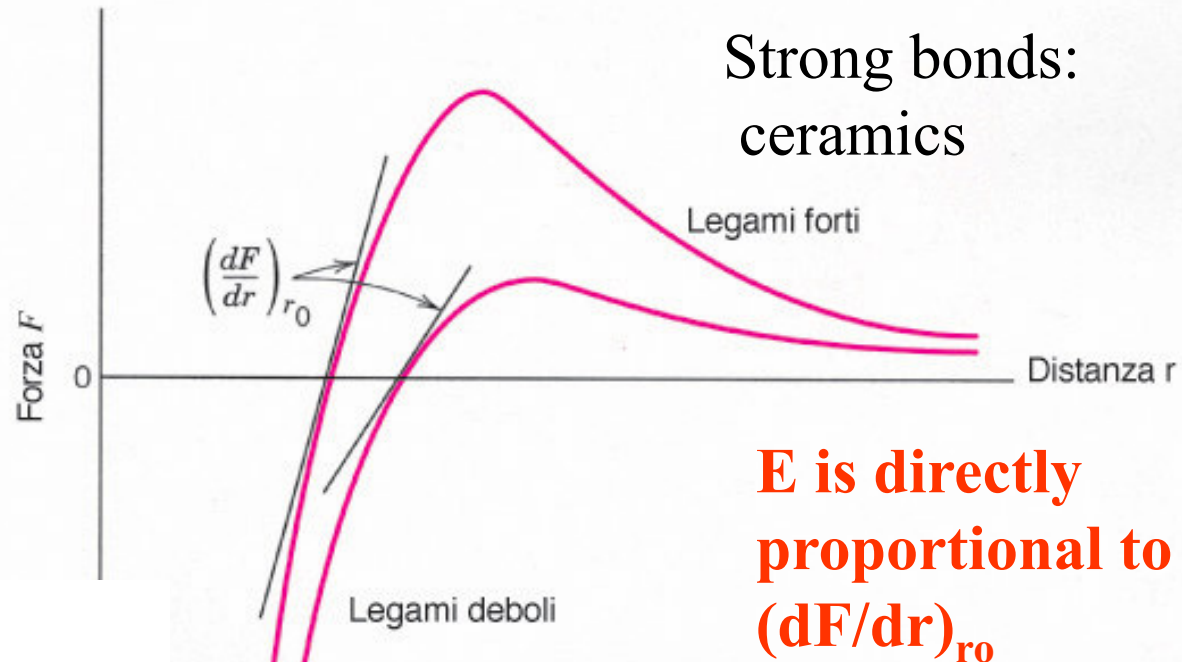
How atomic bonds are responsible of materials properties

# Elastic modulus and bond strength

**FIGURA 6.7**

Curva forza–distanza interatomica per materiali con legami deboli e forti.

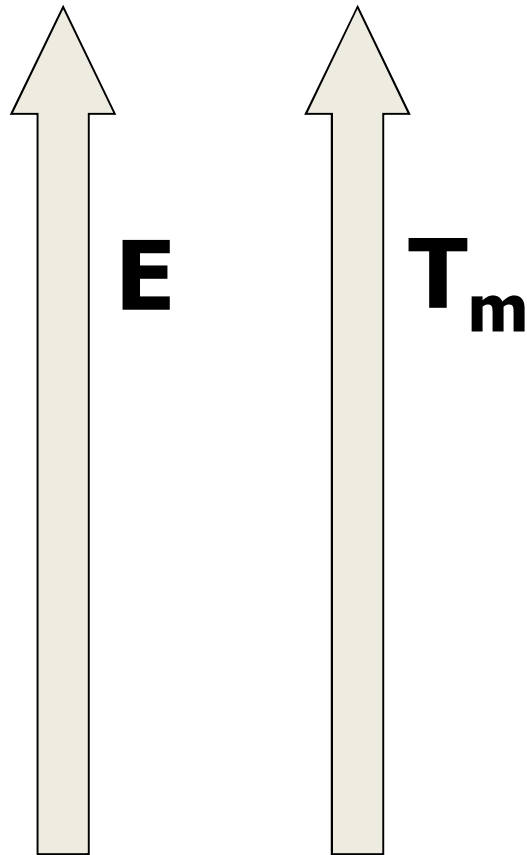
Il valore del modulo elastico è proporzionale alla pendenza di ciascuna curva calcolata alla distanza interatomica di equilibrio  $r_0$ .



Weak bonds: polymers

a introduzione

# Elastic modulus and melting temperature



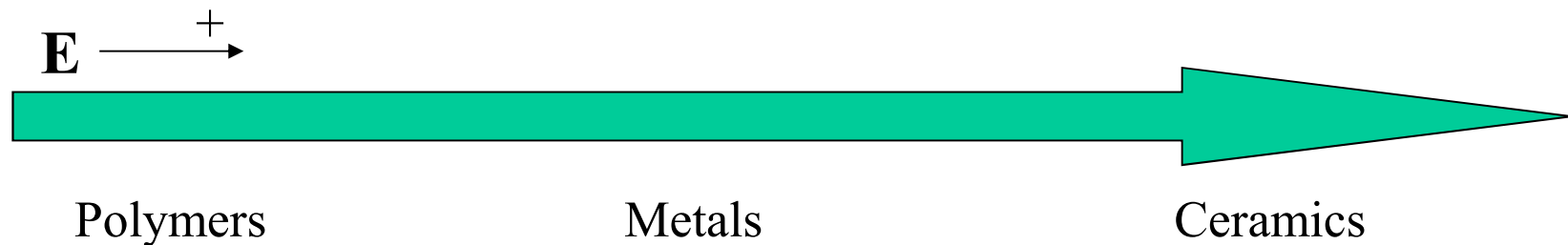
| Material                       | Temp<br>melting [ $^{\circ}$ C] | E<br>(GPa) |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|------------|
| TiC                            | 3160                            | 310        |
| Al <sub>2</sub> O <sub>3</sub> | 2045                            | 370        |
| W                              | 3410                            | 393        |
| Fe                             | 1536                            | 207        |
| Cu                             | 1083                            | 111        |
| Al                             | 660                             | 70         |
| Pb                             | 327                             | 14         |
| Polyethylene                   | 130                             | 1          |
| glasses                        | -                               | 70-90      |

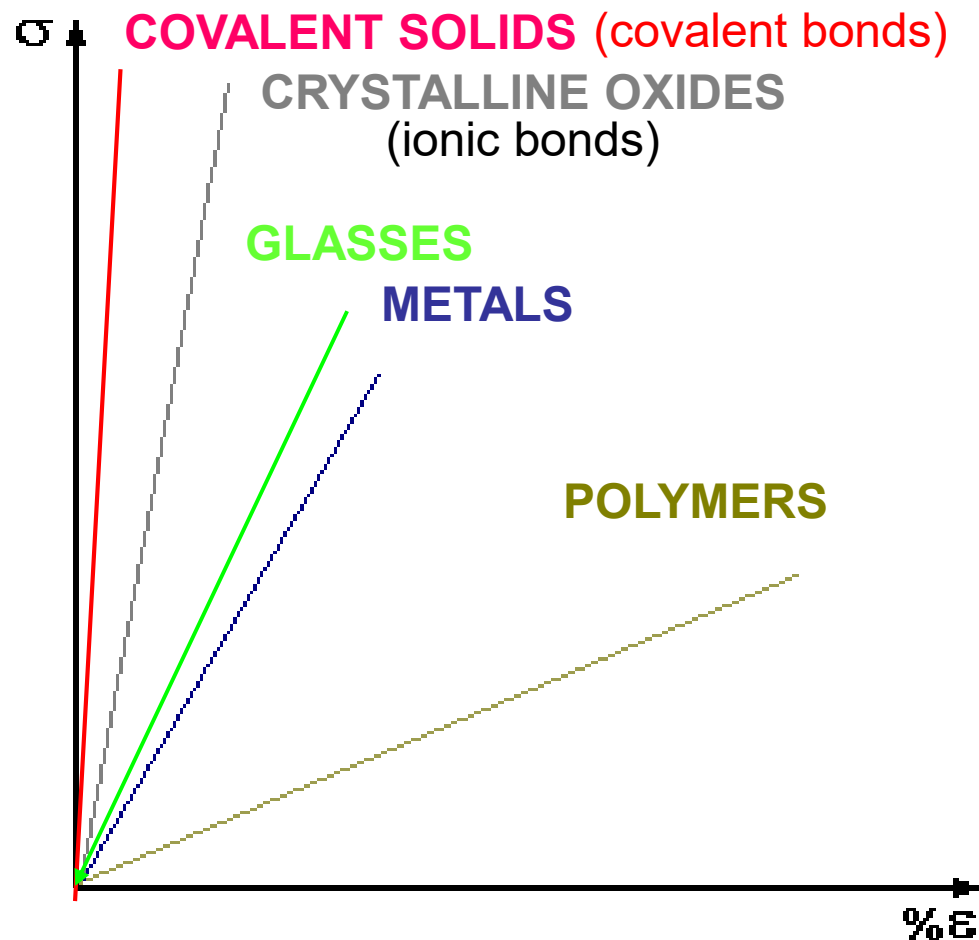


| <b>Materiale</b>                   | <b><math>E</math> (GPa)</b> | <b>Materiale</b>                             | <b><math>E</math> (GPa)</b> |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>Diamond</b>                     | $10^3$                      | <b>Ti and its alloy</b>                      | 85-130                      |
| <b>WC</b>                          | 500-600                     | <b>Zn and its alloy</b>                      | 45-95                       |
| <b>SiC</b>                         | 450                         | <b>Al and its alloy</b>                      | 70-80                       |
| <b>Al<sub>2</sub>O<sub>3</sub></b> | 300-400                     | <b>Mg and its alloy</b>                      | 40-45                       |
| <b>TiC</b>                         | 320                         | <b>GFRP *</b>                                | 10-40                       |
| <b>Ni</b>                          | 215                         | <b>Wood <math>\parallel</math> to fibers</b> | 10-15                       |
| <b>Steel</b>                       | 195-215                     | <b>Wood <math>\perp</math> to fibers</b>     | 0,5-1                       |
| <b>CFRP**</b>                      | 100-200                     | <b>Plastics</b>                              | $10^{-1}$ -5                |
| <b>Copper and its alloy</b>        | 120-150                     | <b>Expanded plastic</b>                      | $10^{-3}$ - $10^{-2}$       |

**\*Glass fiber reinforced polymers**

**\*\*C fiber reinforced polymer**





Young's modulus depends on some parameters:

**- Bonding energy**

Stronger chemical bonds  
 → higher bonding energy  
 → higher **E**

**- Amorphous vs. crystalline structure**

Amorphous materials show lower **E** than crystalline ones

**More than 4 orders of magnitude** between **E** of diamond and **E** of polymers!

Which of these materials is «BRITTLE»?

Which is «FRAGILE»?

Why?

The elastic modulus  $E$  is assumed to be (almost) independent of alloying elements (e.g. interstitial atoms)  $\rightarrow E = 210 \text{ GPa}$

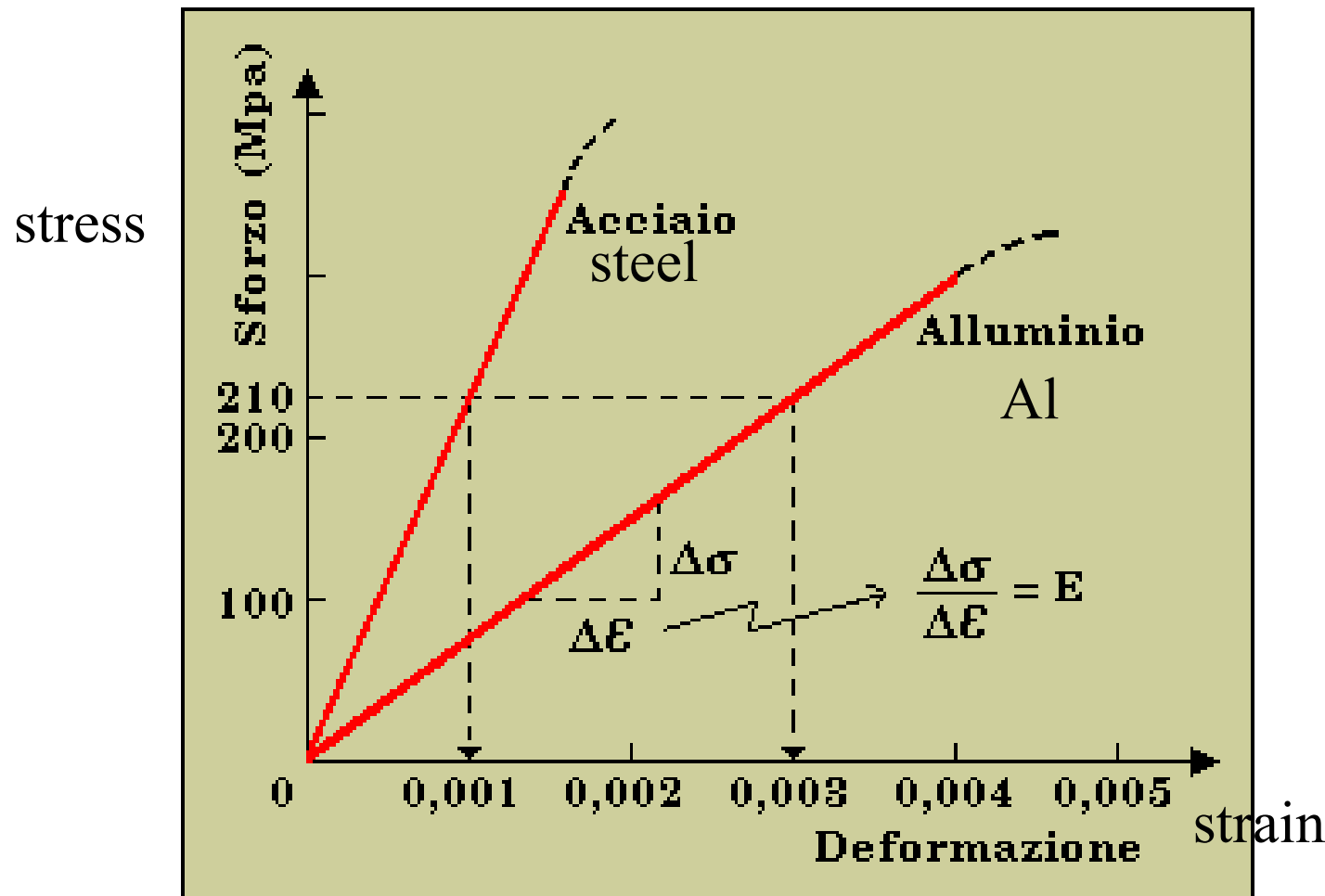
Low amount of alloying elements  $\rightarrow$  the mean energy of the bond remains constant  $\rightarrow E = \text{cost}$

High amount of alloying elements  $\rightarrow E = 190\text{-}230 \text{ GPa}$

**THE ELASTIC MODULUS IS NOT RELATED TO THE MOVEMENT OF DISLOCATIONS!**

|                      |                              | Modulo di elasticità alla trazione<br>$E$<br>N/mm <sup>2</sup> |
|----------------------|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ferro                | Fe 37/360                    | 190000                                                         |
| Ferro                | Fe 430                       | 200000                                                         |
| Ferro                | Fe 510                       | 210000                                                         |
| Acciaio non legato   | C40                          | 220000                                                         |
| Acciaio non legato   | C 45                         | 220000                                                         |
| Acciaio legato       | 18NiCrMo5                    | 230000                                                         |
| Acciaio legato       | 34CrNiMo6                    | 220000                                                         |
| Acciaio legato       | 42 CrMo 4                    | 230000                                                         |
| Acciaio per cilindri | St35 - St37                  | 200000                                                         |
| Acciaio per cilindri | ST 52                        | 220000                                                         |
| Acciaio per cilindri | ST E 460                     | 220000                                                         |
| Acciaio INOX         | AISI 304<br>X5CrNi 18-10     | 196000                                                         |
| Acciaio INOX         | AISI 316<br>X5CrNiMo 17-12-2 | 196000                                                         |
| Acciaio INOX         | AISI 410<br>X12 Cr 13        | 198000                                                         |
| Acciaio INOX         | AISI 420<br>X30 Cr 13        | 198000                                                         |
| Acciaio INOX         | AISI 430<br>X6 Cr 17         | 200000                                                         |
| Acciaio INOX         | AISI 630<br>X5CrNiCuNb 16-4  | 196000                                                         |

# How to measure the elastic modulus: from tensile curve

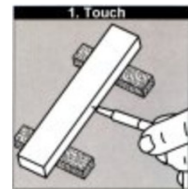


# How to measure the elastic modulus

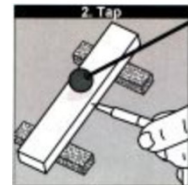
## – Drawbacks of tensile tests:

- ❖ Sample preparation
- ❖ Destructive test
- ❖ Unsuitable for brittle materials
- **Measurement of the elastic modulus by compression or bending tests, indentations...**
- **Non destructive tests**

TOUCH



TAP



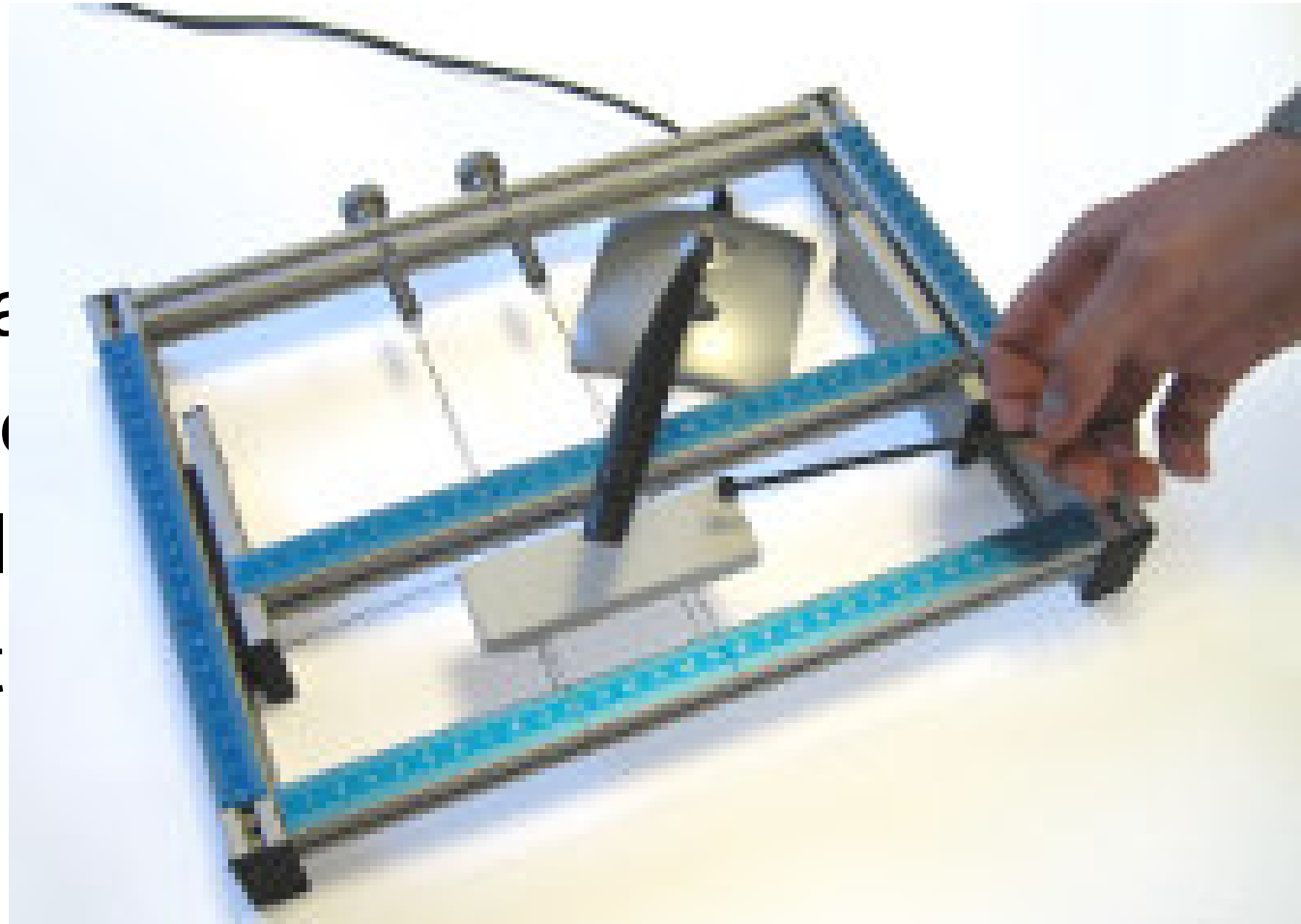
READ



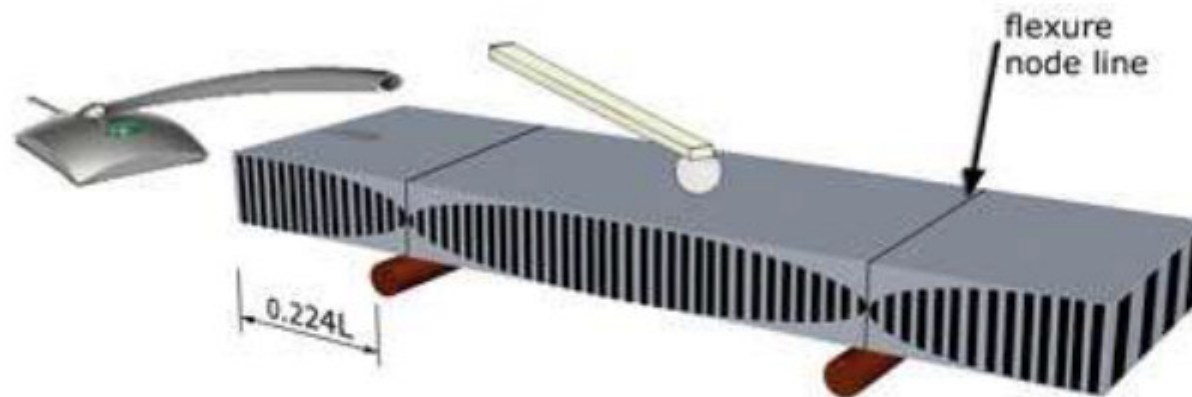
# Elastic modulus by sonic test

- **$E = 0.9465 * (\Gamma v^2 L^4 \rho / t^2)$**

- $\Gamma$  = constant
- $v$  = sonic wave velocity
- $L$  = sample length
- $\rho$  = material density
- $t$  = sample thickness

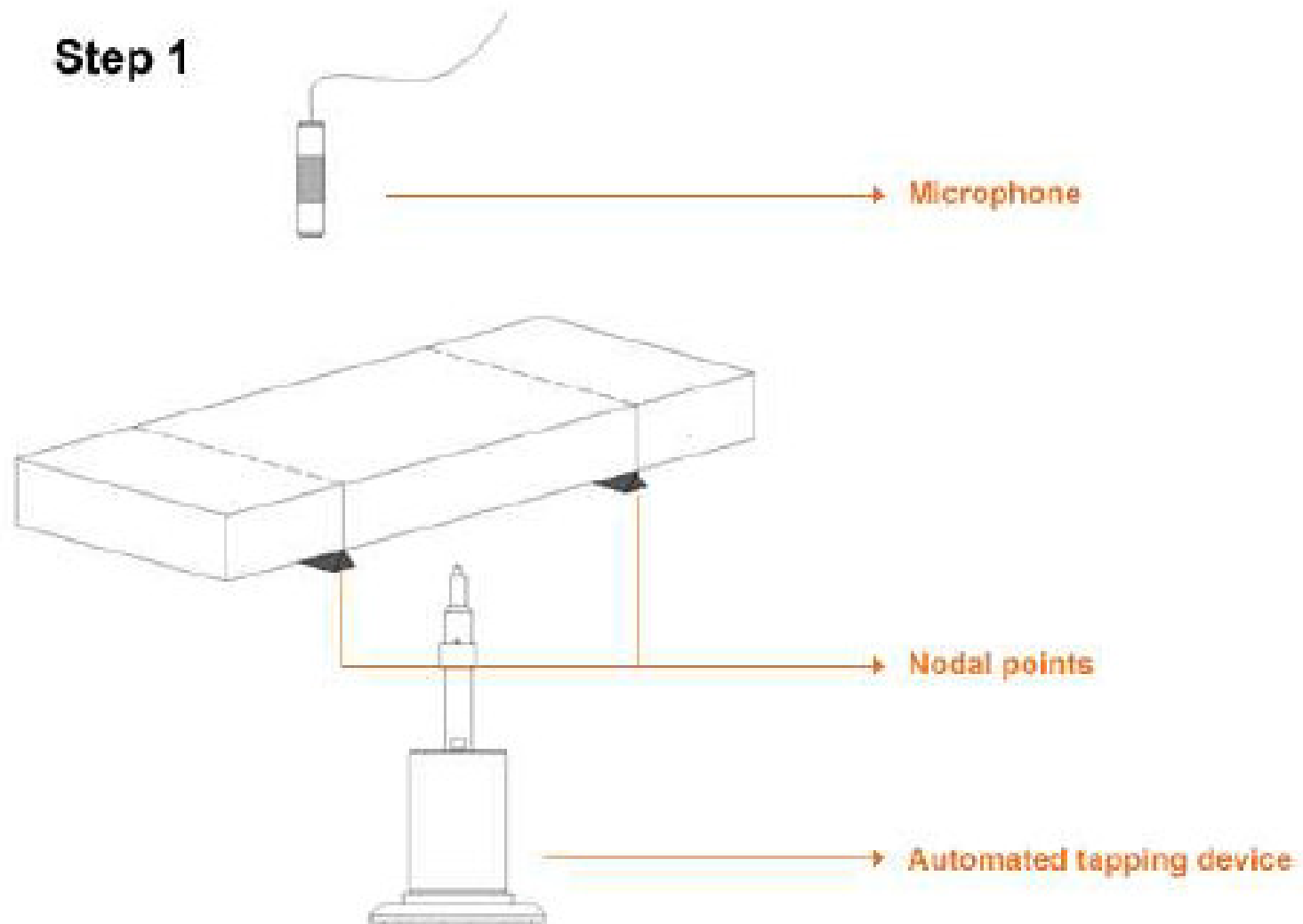


# The Principle of Impulse Excitation



- Figure 1. A method for supporting a rectangular bar to induce the flexural mode of vibration. The sample is supported on two knife edges placed at the standing wave nodes, which occur at 0.224 of the length from each end. The bar then flexes freely in and out of its plane, as indicated by the vertical lines.
- ASTM standards E1867 and C1259

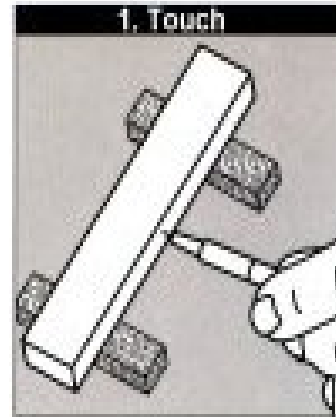
**Step 1**





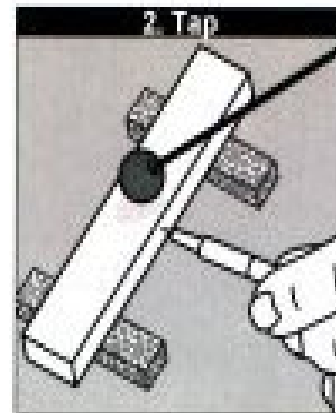
# Measuring elastic modulus (E) by GrindoSonic

- ☺ Useful for highly porous samples
- ☺ Very useful for quality control!
- ☺ No limitations on size
- ☹ Limitations on geometry



## Touch

In the majority of cases, a piezo-electric detector is used to capture the vibrations, and to convert it into an electrical signal. The point of the detector is simply brought into contact with the sample.



## Tap

The sample is excited into vibration through the means of a light tap. Very little energy is required.

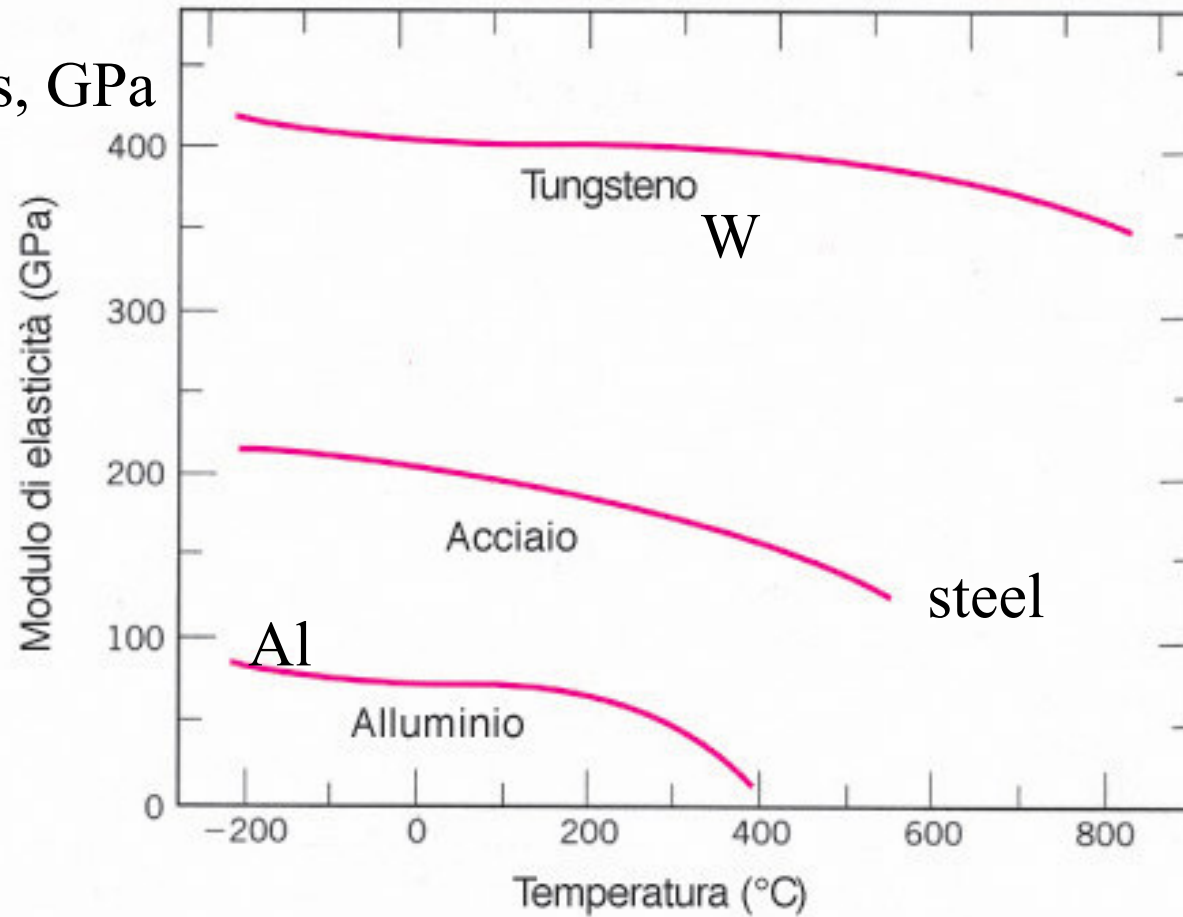


## Read

Almost immediately the numerical result is displayed on the front panel. A few moments later the display is cleared and the instrument is ready for the next measurement.

# Elastic modulus vs T

Elastic modulus, GPa



# ELASTIC MODULUS IN COMPOSITES

**Mixture rule:** elastic modulus is a weighted average, based on the volumetric fraction, of the elastic moduli of the components:

$$E_c = E_1 \cdot f_{v1} + E_2 \cdot f_{v2} + \dots E_n \cdot f_{vn}$$

Composite with **50% vol. C fibres + 50% vol. polymeric matrix**

Carbon fibers:  $E \approx 200 \text{ GPa}$

Polymer:  $E \approx 0.6 \text{ GPa}$

Composite  $E \approx (200 \cdot 0.5 + 0.6 \cdot 0.5) \approx 100 \text{ GPa}$

Composite **30% vol. C fibres + 70% vol. polymeric matrix**

Composite  $E \approx (200 \cdot 0.3 + 0.6 \cdot 0.7) \approx 60 \text{ GPa}$

# Elastic modulus of a steel vs T

## Physical properties

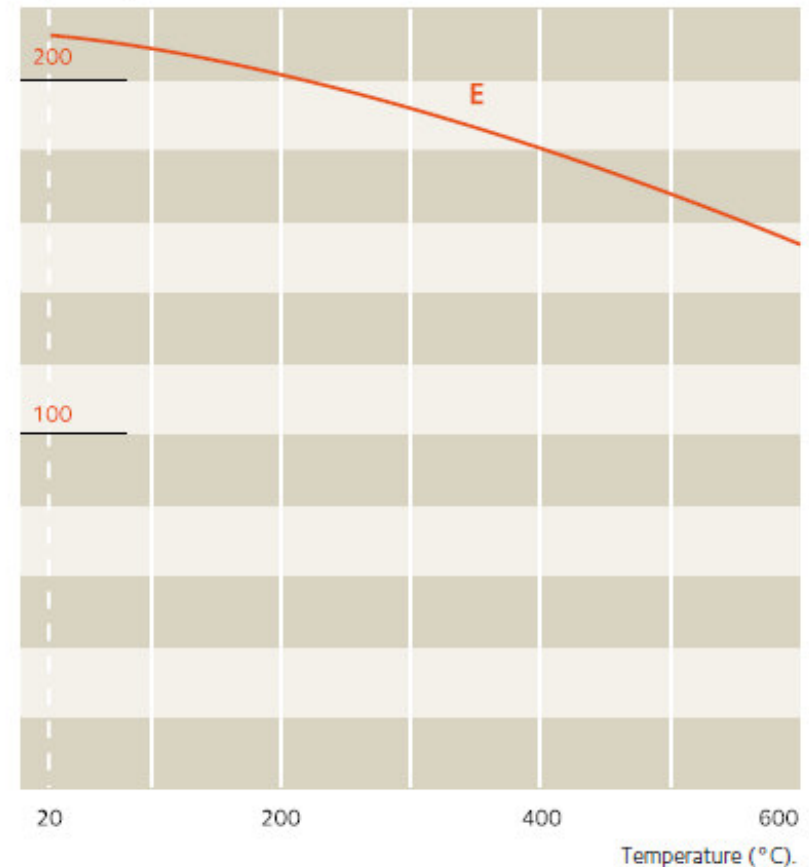
(Cold rolled sheet – annealed\*)

|                                       |   |                      |                                              |                            |
|---------------------------------------|---|----------------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Density                               | d | kg/dm <sup>3</sup>   | 20°C                                         | 7.7                        |
| Melting temperature                   |   | °C                   |                                              | 1500                       |
| Specific heat                         | c | J/kg.K               | 20°C                                         | 450                        |
| Thermal conductivity                  | k | W/m.K                | 20°C                                         | 21.3                       |
| Mean coefficient of thermal expansion | a | 10 <sup>-6</sup> /K  | 20–200°C<br>20–400°C<br>20–600°C<br>20–800°C | 11.5<br>12<br>12.6<br>13.5 |
| Electric resistivity                  | ρ | Ω.mm <sup>2</sup> /m | 20°C                                         | 0.70                       |
| Magnetic permeability                 | μ | at 0.8 kA/m DC or AC | 20°C                                         | 550                        |
| Young's modulus                       | E | MPa.10 <sup>3</sup>  | 20°C                                         | 210                        |

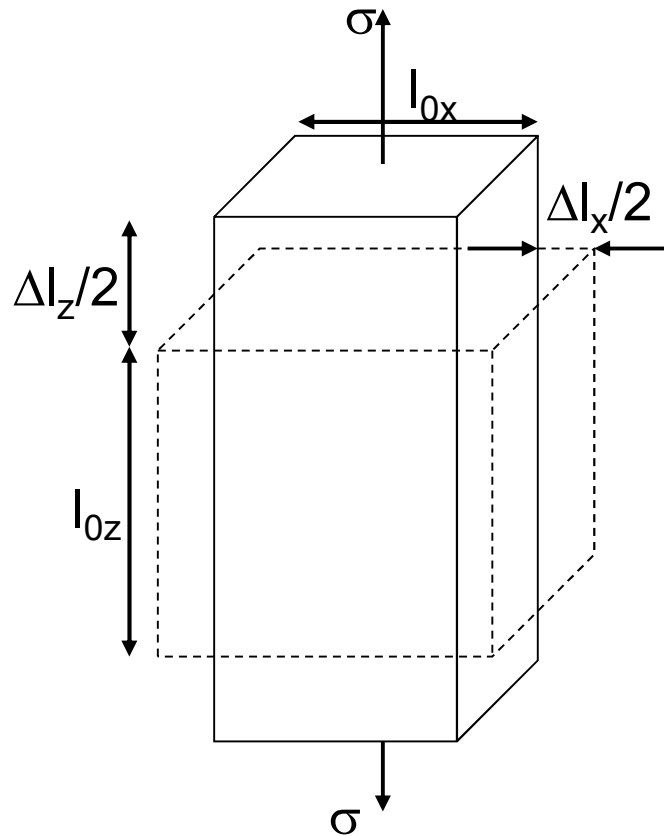
\* Typical values.

## Young's modulus at high temperature

E (10<sup>3</sup> MPa)



# Poisson coefficient ( $\nu$ )



$$\nu = -\frac{\epsilon_x}{\epsilon_z}$$
$$= -\frac{\epsilon_y}{\epsilon_z}$$

Metals: about 0.33

Ceramics: 0.17 - 0.27

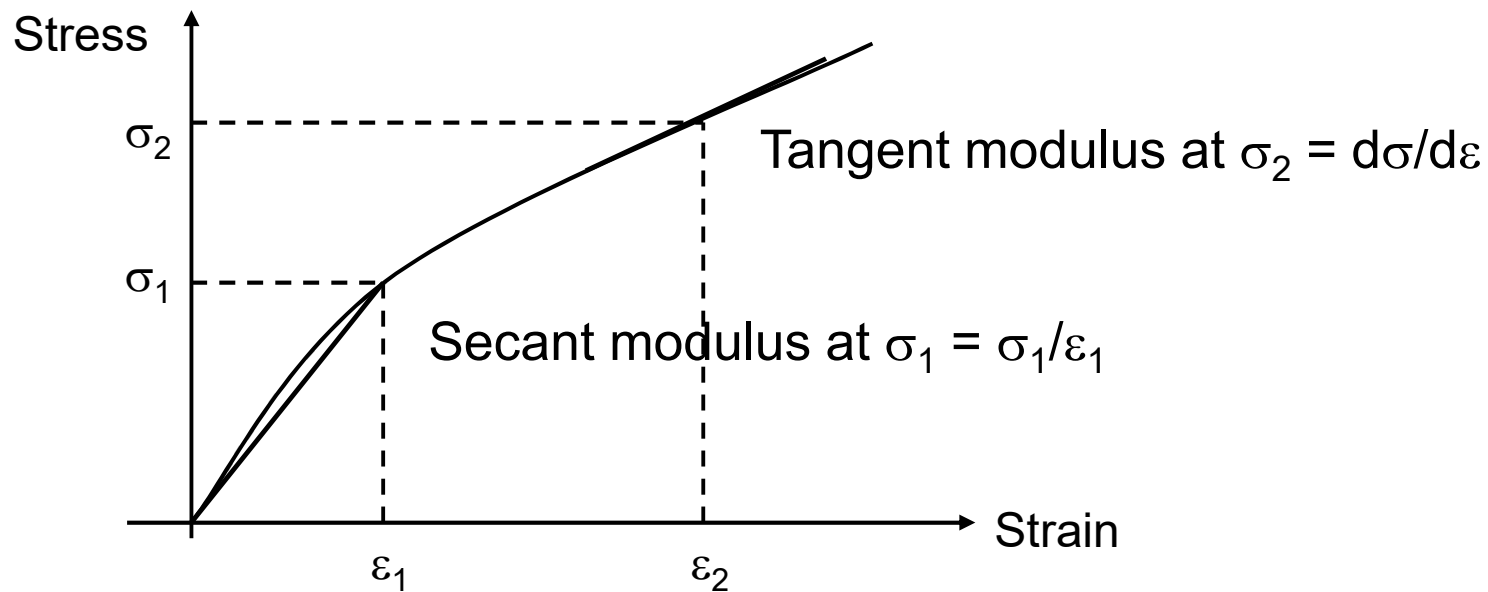
Polymers: 0.33 - 0.5

The Poisson coeff. is always  $< 0.5$

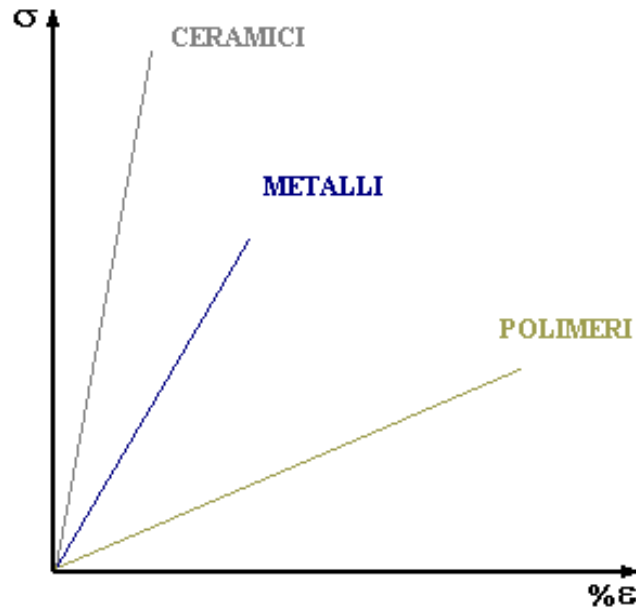
- $\epsilon_x$ ,  $\epsilon_y$  and  $\epsilon_z$  have opposite sign

# Non linear elastic behaviour

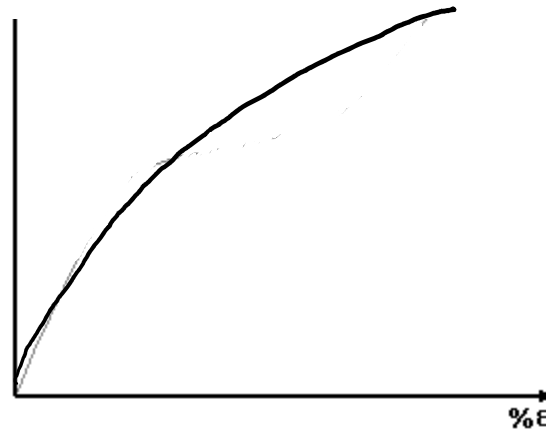
- Some polymers, cast iron, concrete,....
- $E$  calculated locally



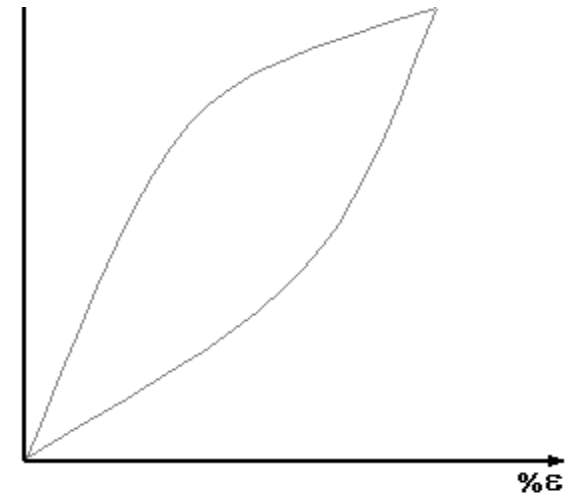
# Summary



**Linear elastic  
Behaviour**  
(most materials)



**Non linear elastic  
behaviour**  
(some polymers,  
cast iron,  
concrete,...)



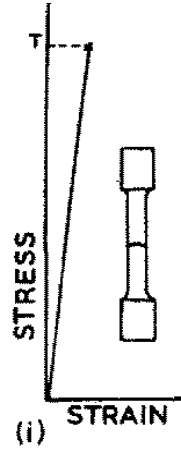
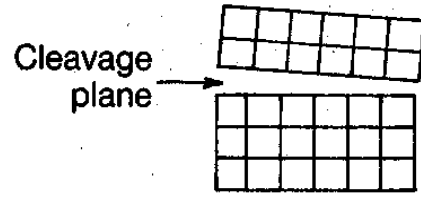
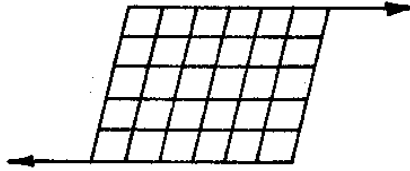
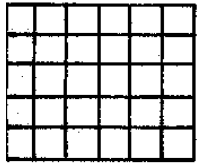
**Anelastic behaviour**  
Time is required to  
recover deformation  
after stress removal  
(some polymers)

# Plastic deformation and chemical bond

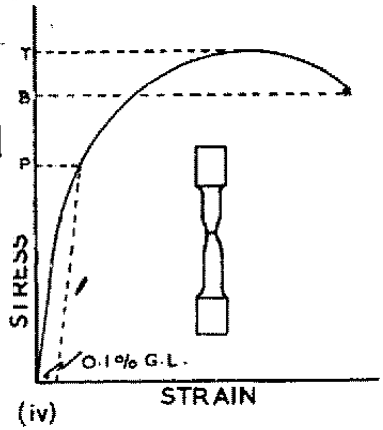
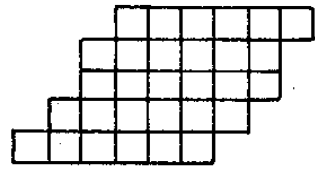
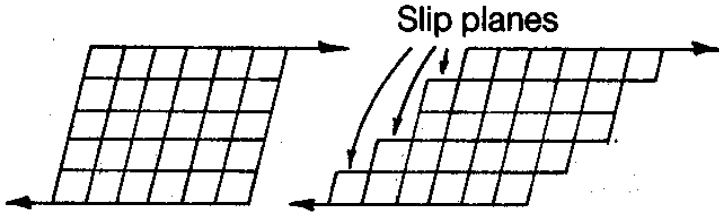
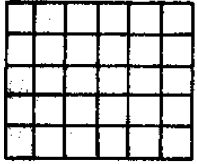
- When applied stresses increases and corresponding deformations are higher than about 0.002, **the Hooke law does not work any more.**
- Bonds start breaking and, **if possible**, other bonds are formed in different positions
- If the load is removed, the sample recovers only the elastic deformation, but **a plastic, permanent deformation is evident.**
- The frontier between elastic and plastic deformation is defined **yield strength or limit of proportionality**



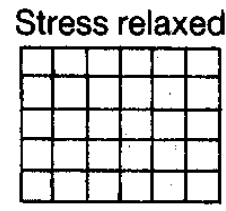
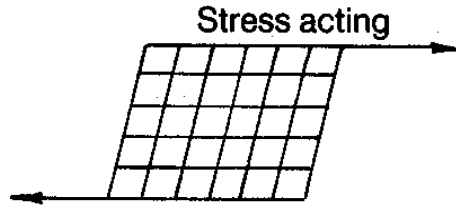
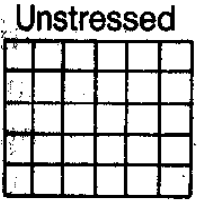
# BRITTLE FRACTURE (CLEAVAGE)



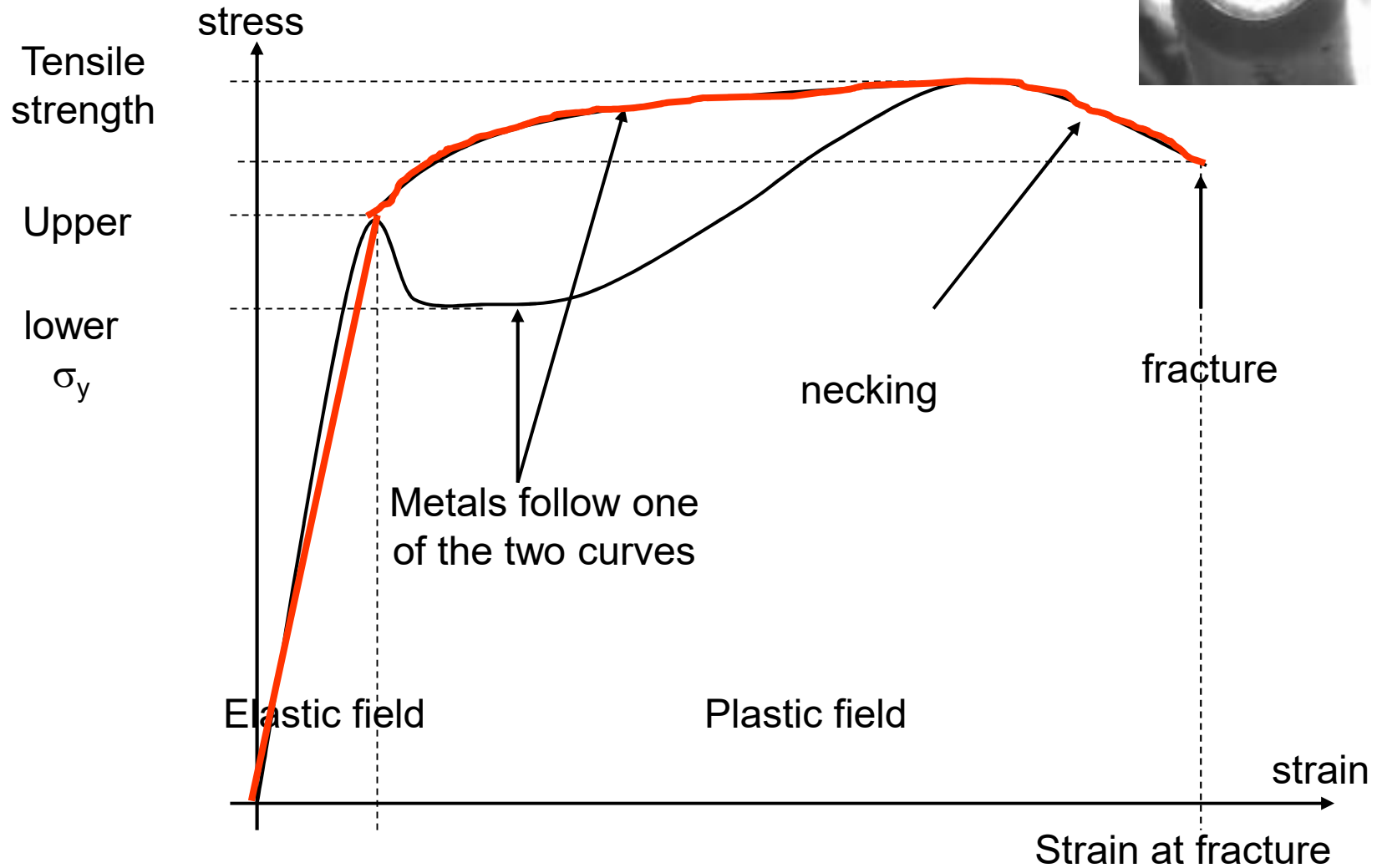
# PLASTIC DEFORMATION



# ELASTIC DEFORMATION



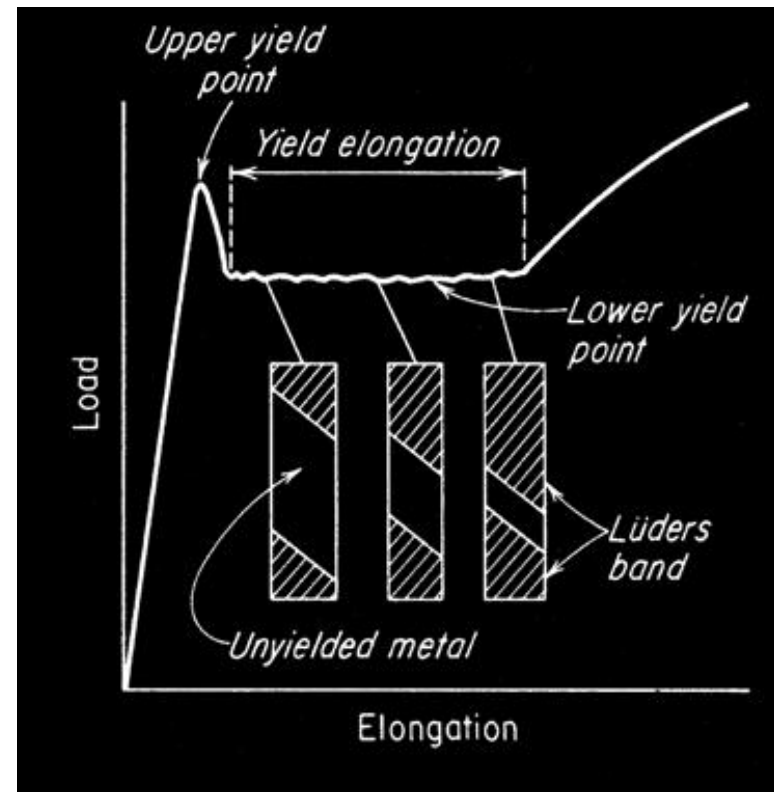
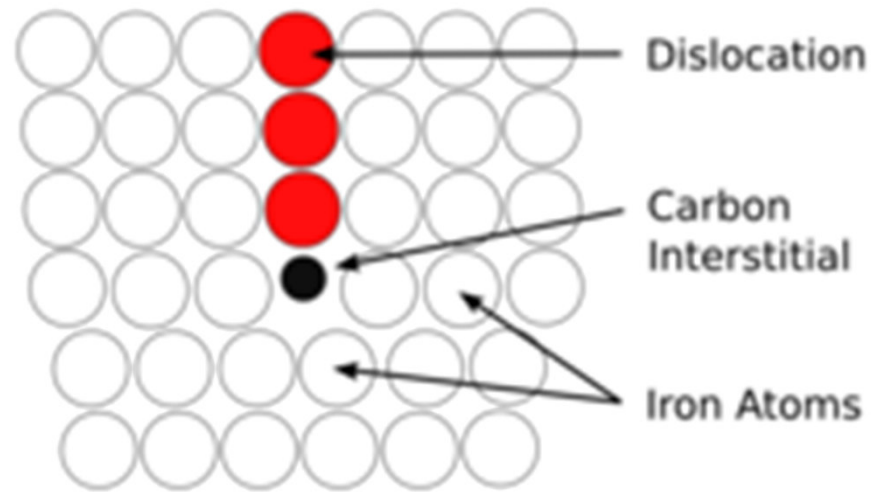
# $\sigma$ – $\varepsilon$ curve for metals



In steel we have interstitial C, causing the dislocations to pin (to stop).

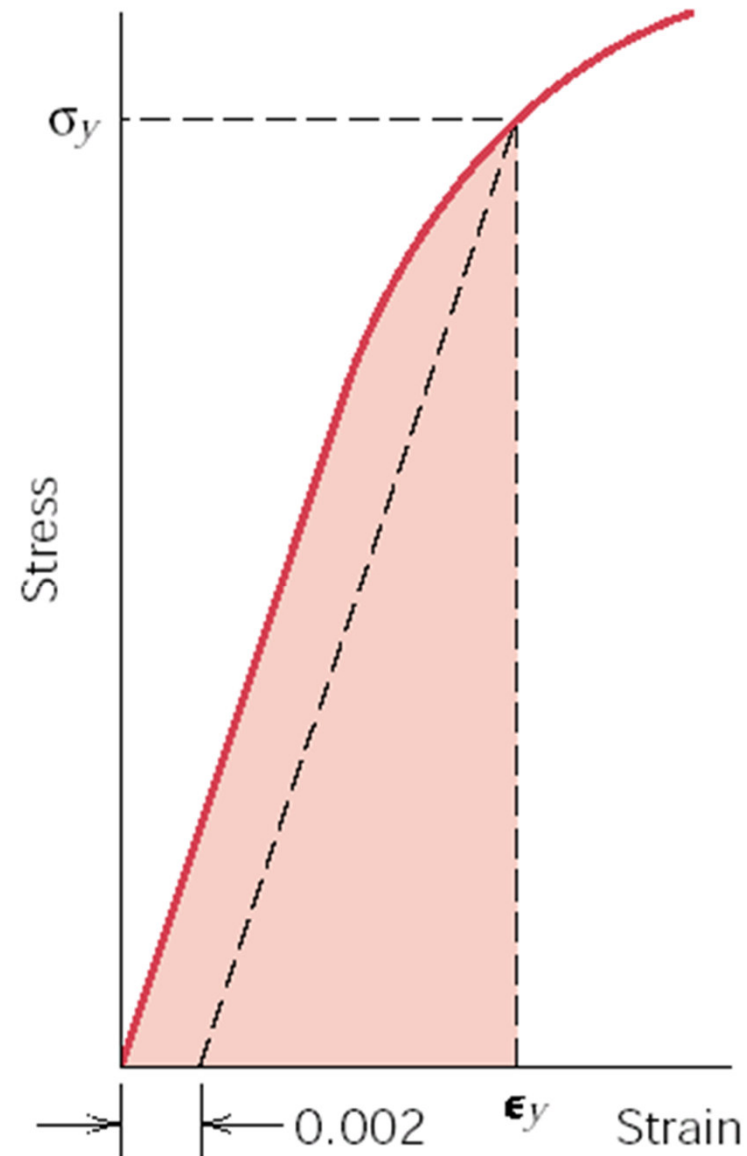
Thus, it becomes difficult for dislocation to move and we need higher load to make them to move (upper yield point).

Then, the pinning will be gone and dislocations can move freely and we need smaller load to keep them moving (plastic deformation going) → lower yield point.



Yield strength at 0.2 % strain (0.002)

This type of monotonic curve is observed, for example, in pure metals, FCC alloys, Al alloys.

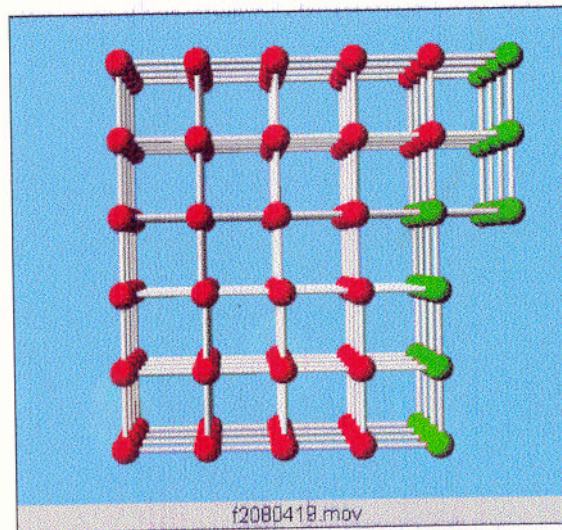
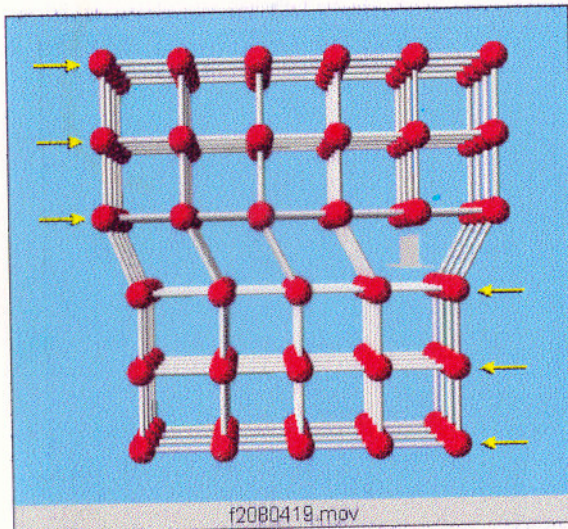
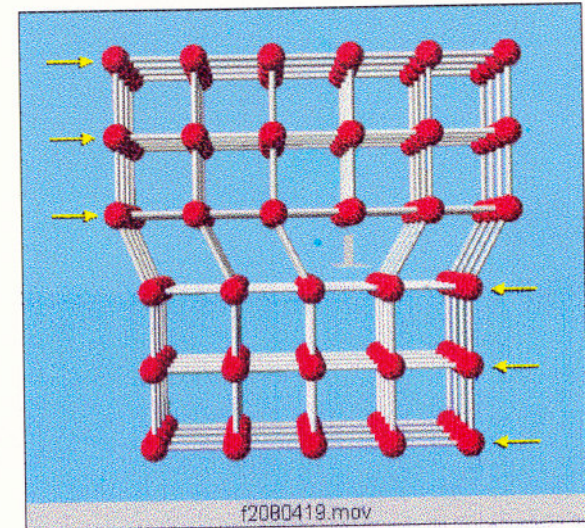
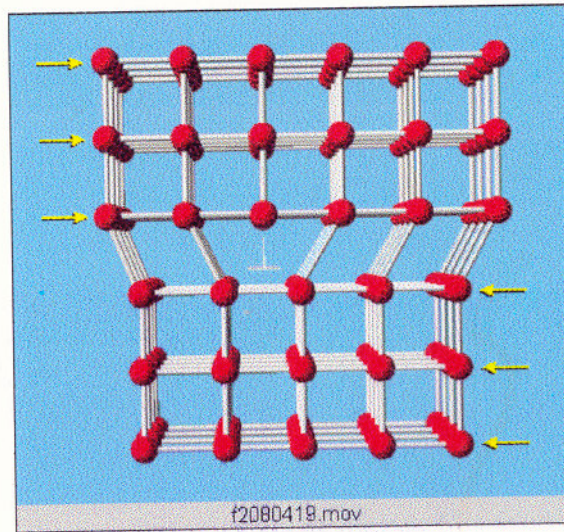
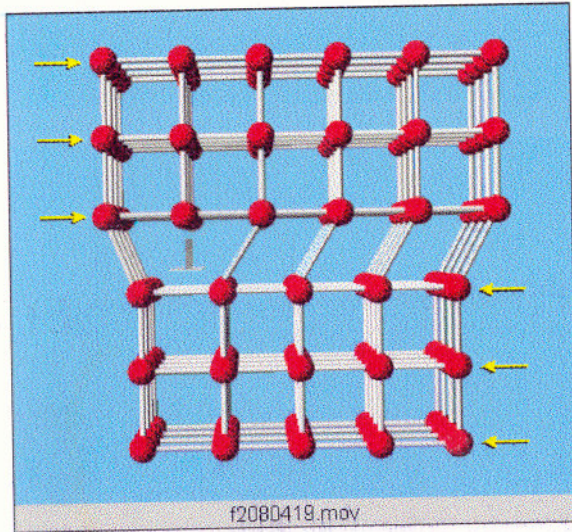


# Yield strength for different materials

|                     | $\sigma_y$ [MPa] |
|---------------------|------------------|
| <b>steels</b>       | 250-1400         |
| <b>Ni alloys</b>    | 200-1600         |
| <b>Ti alloys</b>    | 200-1300         |
| <b>Cu alloys</b>    | 60-950           |
| <b>Al alloys</b>    | 100-650          |
| <b>Mg alloys</b>    | 80-300           |
| <b>Epoxy resins</b> | 30-100           |
| <b>nylon</b>        | 50-90            |
| <b>polystyrene</b>  | 35-70            |
| <b>ABS</b>          | 50               |
| <b>polyethylene</b> | 6-30             |



# Yield strength and dislocations



Dislocations explain the 3 orders of magnitude between **theoretical** and **experimental** yield strength

Without dislocations, the yield strength would be about  **$E/8$  (GPa)**

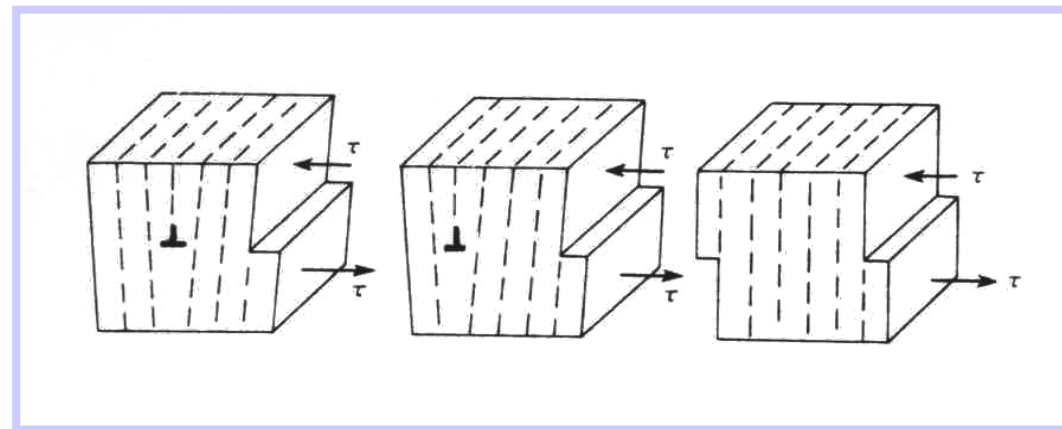
| Material                          | Tensile | Yield Stress (psi)                |
|-----------------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------|
| pure (99.45%) annealed Al         |         | $4 \times 10^3$ (1 MPa = 145 psi) |
| pure (99.45%) cold drawn Al       |         | $24 \times 10^3$                  |
| Al alloy - precipitated, hardened |         | $50 \times 10^3$                  |

a "perfect" single crystal of pure Al

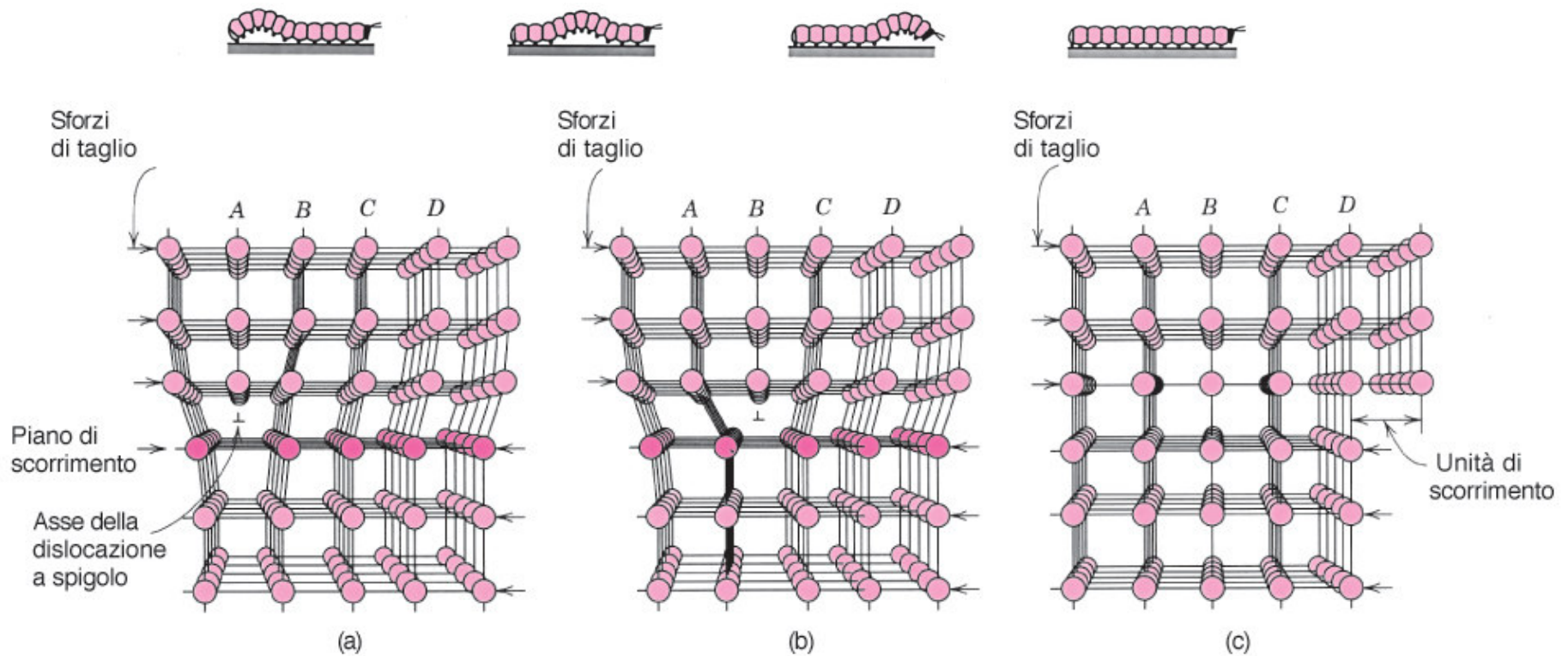
ca.  $10^6$

When you have slipping of crystalline planes in a real crystal (with dislocation), a lower amount of chemical bonds will break compared to a perfect crystal (without dislocations) → **lower yield stress**

*Technological implications?*



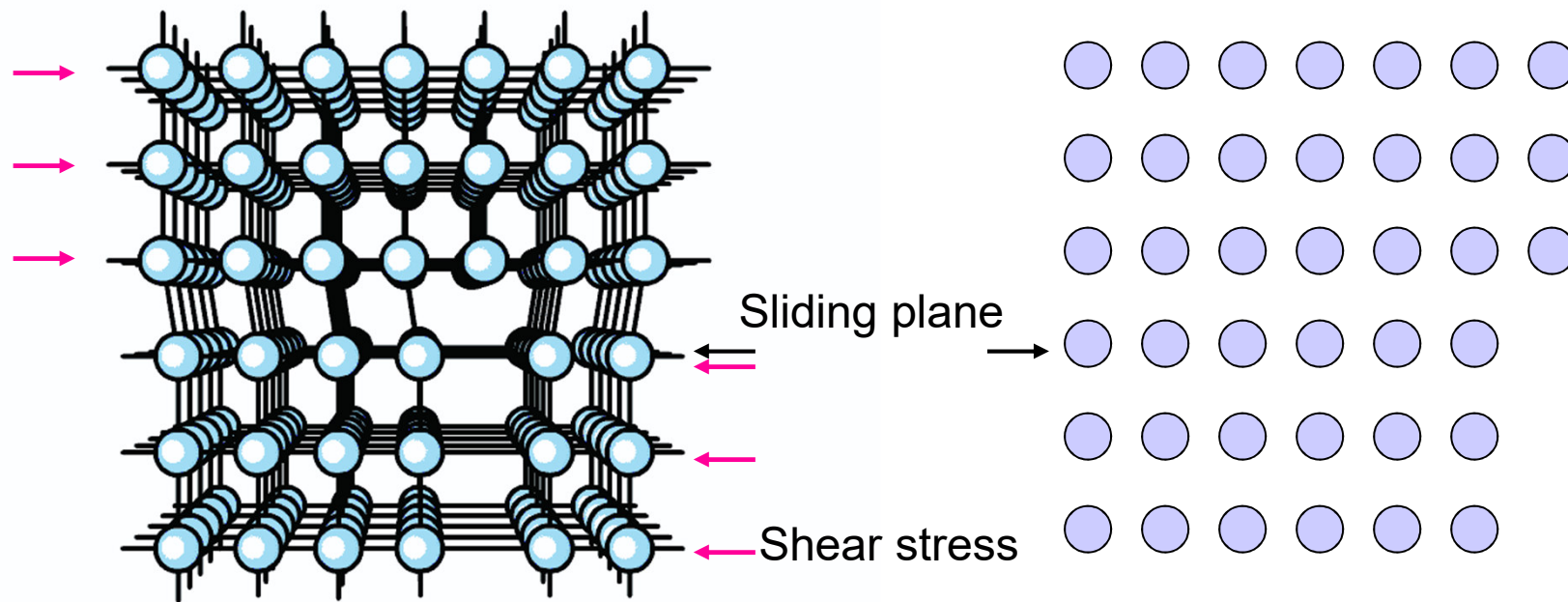




**FIGURA 7.1** Ridisposizione degli atomi causata dal moto di una dislocazione a spigolo sollecitata da uno sforzo di taglio. (a) Il semipiano aggiuntivo è indicato con A. (b) La dislocazione si sposta a destra di una distanza interatomica non appena A si unisce alla parte inferiore del piano B; nel processo, la parte superiore di B diventa il semipiano aggiuntivo. (c) Quando il semipiano aggiuntivo raggiunge la superficie del cristallo si forma un gradino. (Da A.G. Guy, *Essenzial of Materials Science*, McGraw-Hill Book Company, New York, 1976, p. 153.)

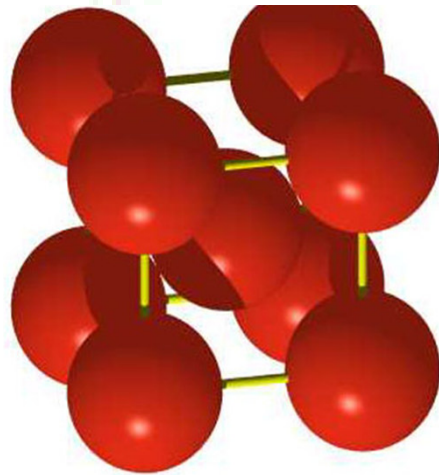
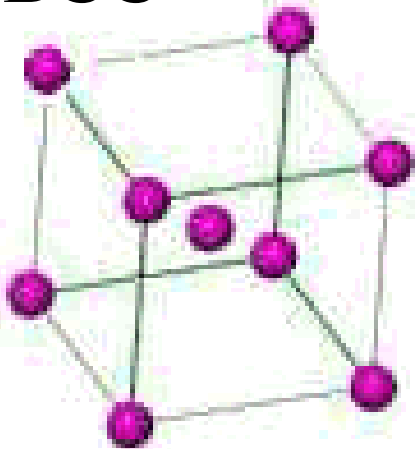


Dislocations provide an effective way for bonds to break and reform in another place, when load is applied.



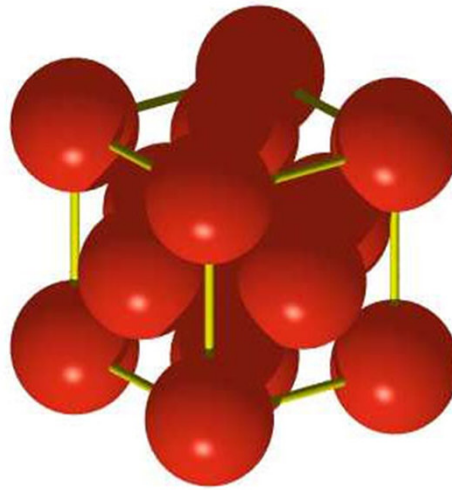
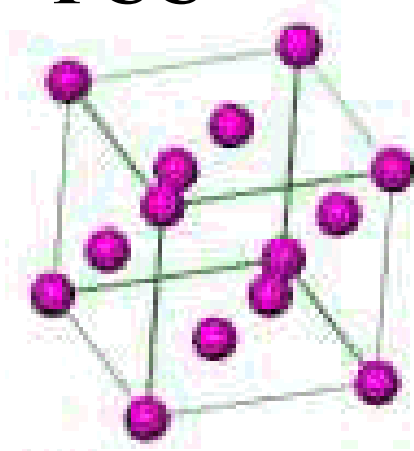
**Dislocation motion is favoured on  
high density sliding planes**

**BCC**



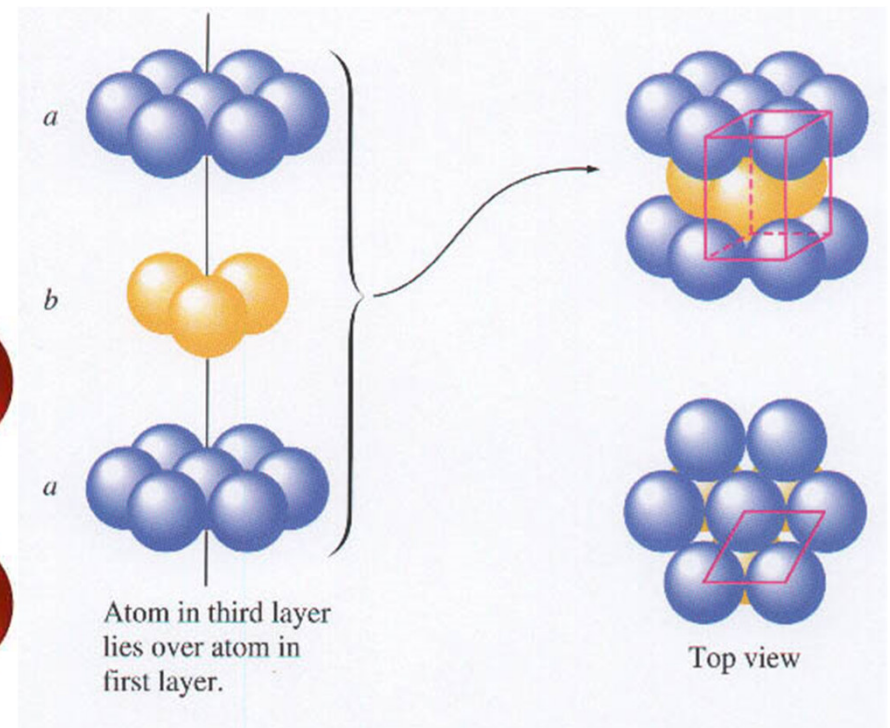
Es: Fe, W, Cr

**FCC**

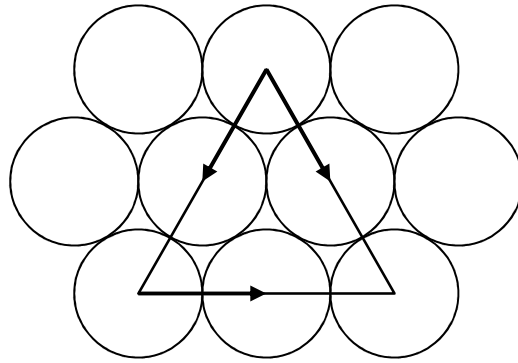
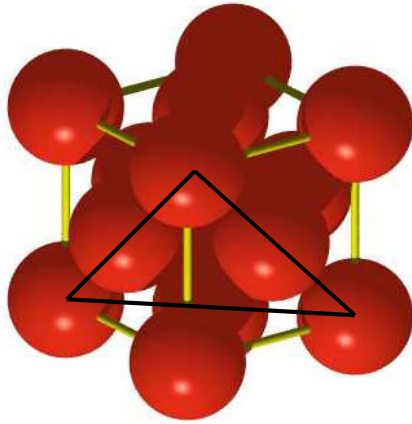


Es: Cu, Al, Ag, Au

**Hexagonal compact**



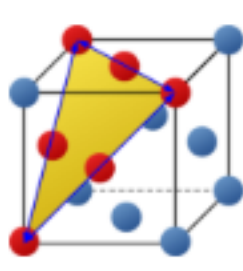
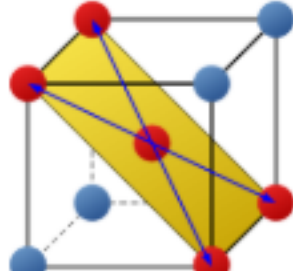
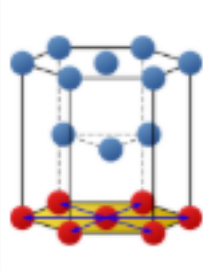
Es: Mg, Ti, Zn



plane (111) for FCC,  
with three sliding  
directions  $\langle 110 \rangle$

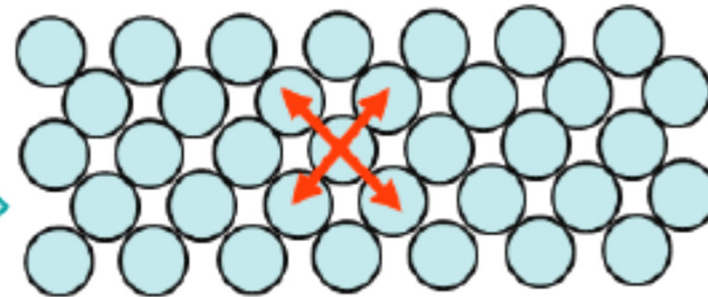
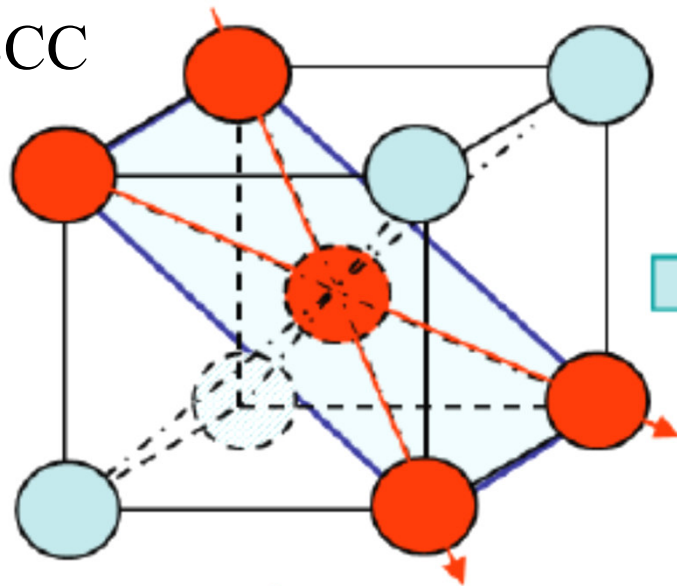
- BCC e FCC have at least 12 sliding planes
- HCP has a maximum of 6 sliding planes
- FCC metals (Cu, Al, Ni, Ag, Au) and BCC (Fe) are ductile, with large plastic deformation
- HCP metals (Ti, Zn) are more brittle

- Number of preferred slip systems
  - <https://www.tec-science.com/material-science/ductility-of-metals/influence-of-the-lattice-structure-on-the-ductility/>
  - FCC (Cu, Al, Ni, Ag, Au) and BCC (Fe) metals have large plastic deformation
  - HCP (Ti, Zn) metals have smaller plastic deformations

|                                  | face-centered cubic (fcc)                                                           | body-centered cubic (bcc)                                                           | hexagonal closest packed (hcp)                                                      |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| lattice structure                |  |  |  |
| number of preferred slip planes  | 4                                                                                   | 6                                                                                   | 1                                                                                   |
| number of slip directions        | 3                                                                                   | 2                                                                                   | 3                                                                                   |
| number of preferred slip systems | 12                                                                                  | 12                                                                                  | 3                                                                                   |
| packing density                  | 74 % (densest packed)                                                               | 68 % (loosely packed)                                                               | 74 % (densest packed)                                                               |
| ductility                        | high                                                                                | medium                                                                              | low                                                                                 |
| metals                           | γ-iron (<1392°C), aluminium, β-cobalt (>417°C), lead, copper, nickel                | α-iron (<911°C), chrome, molybdenum, β-titanium (>882°C), vanadium, tungsten        | α-cobalt(<417°C), α-titanium (<882°C), zinc, magnesium                              |

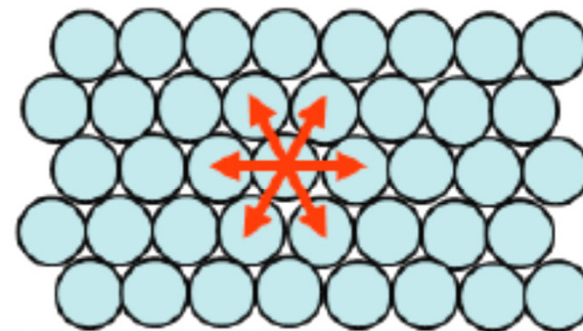
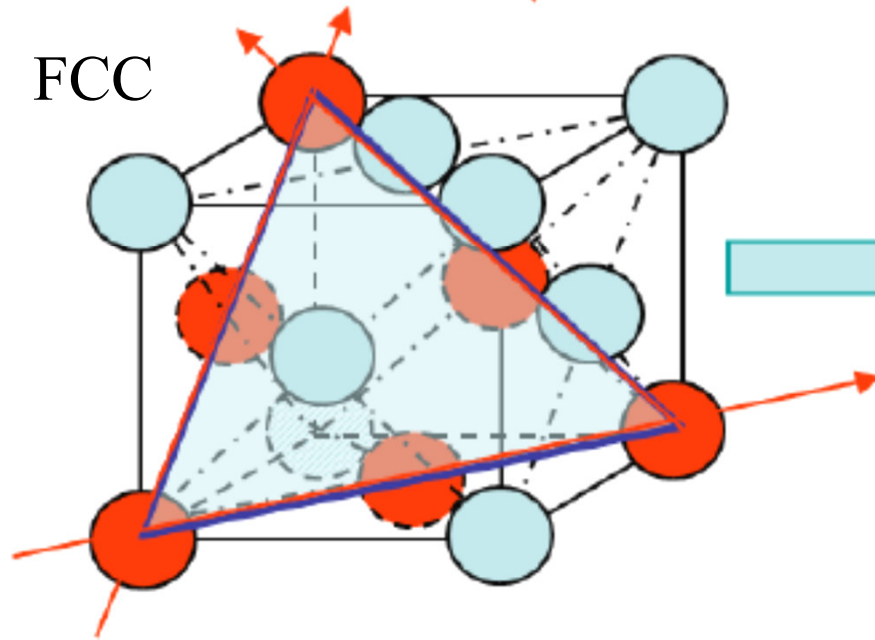
For good deformability, a lattice structure should have at least 5 slip systems to be activated during a deformation process, so that the workpiece can deform in any direction as desired.

BCC



The slip plane is  
not close-packed

FCC



Many close-packed  
directions in a close  
packed plane



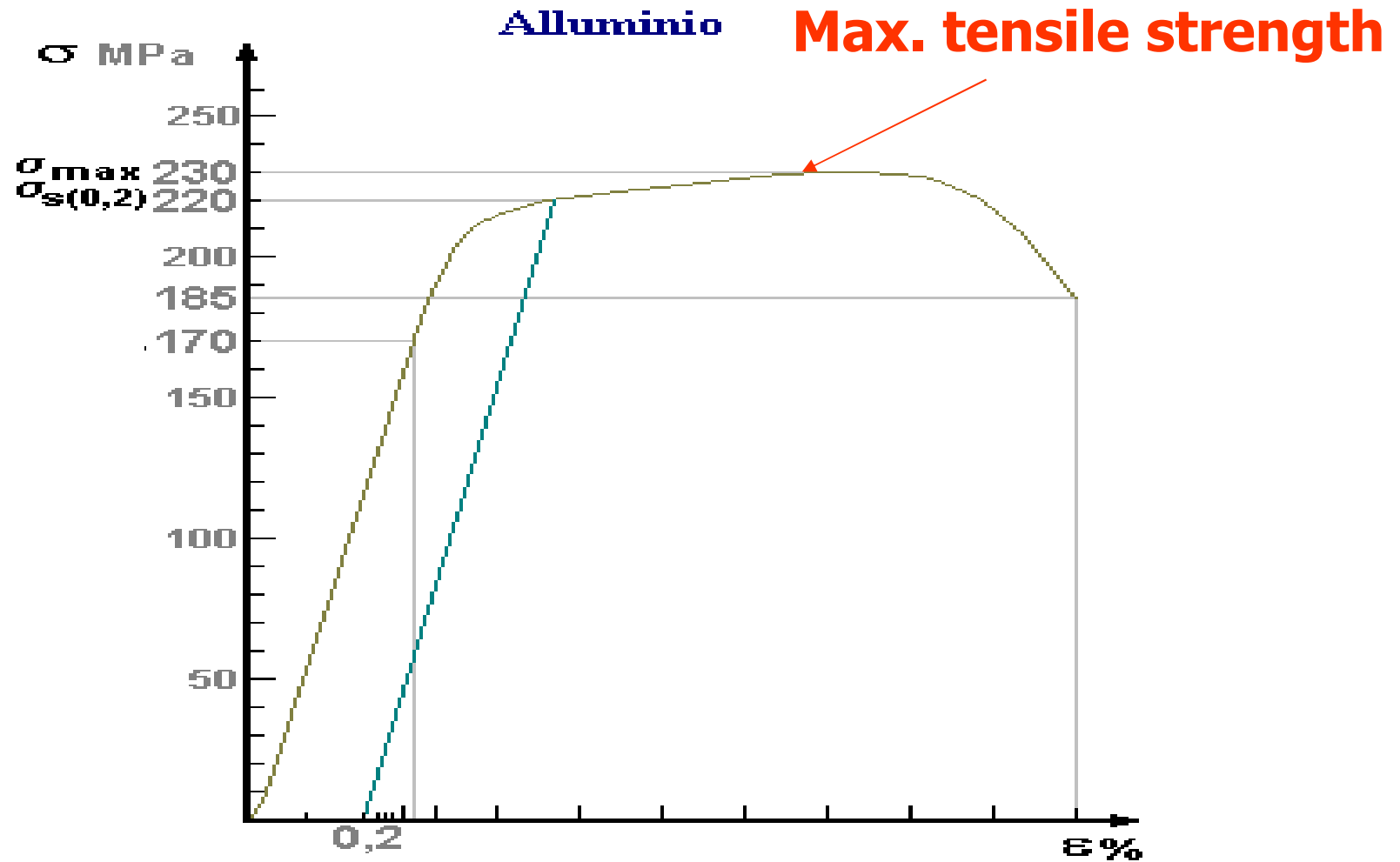
- Plastic deformation of grains in a stainless steel after lamination



After deformation

from Callister

# Stress-strain curve for Al

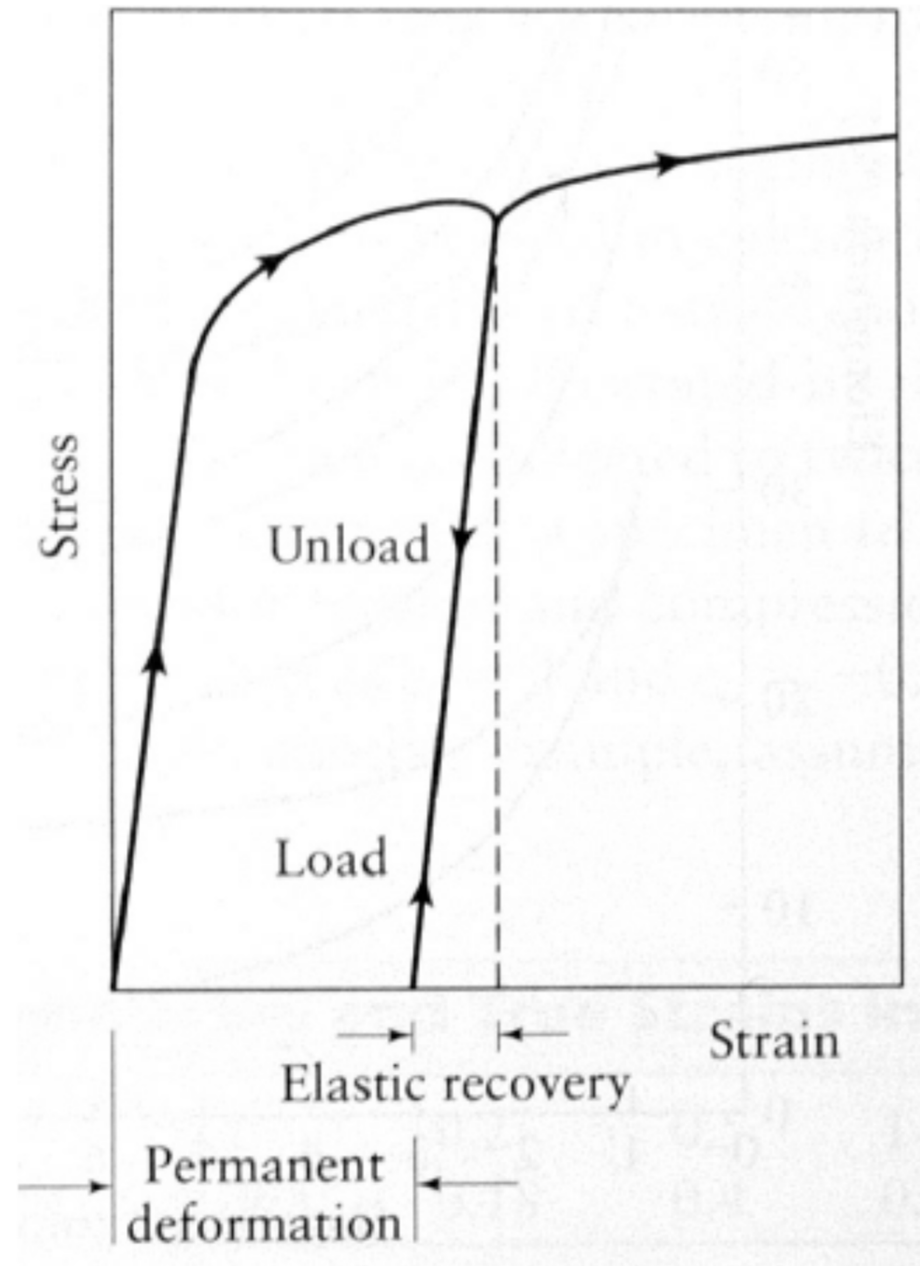


/

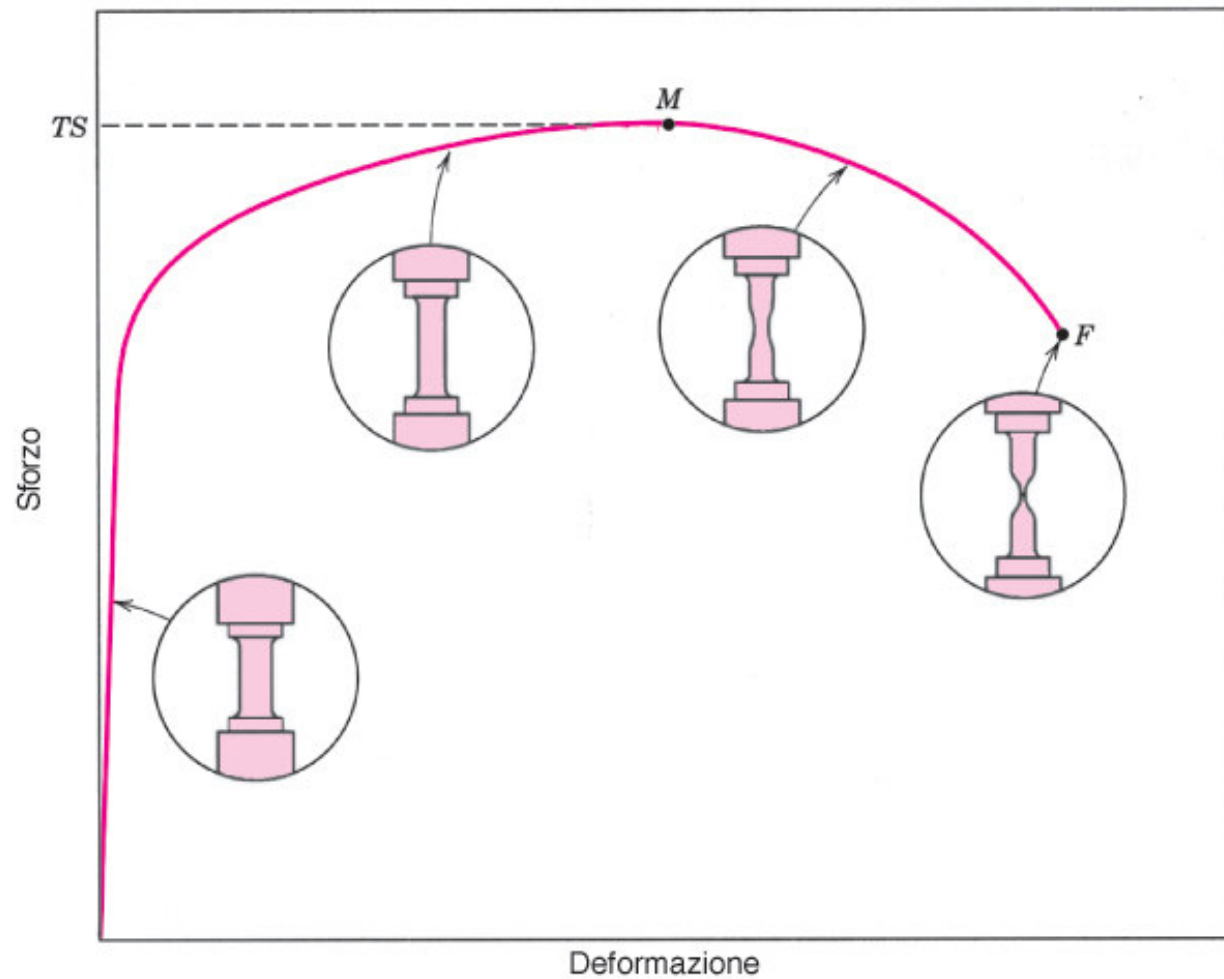


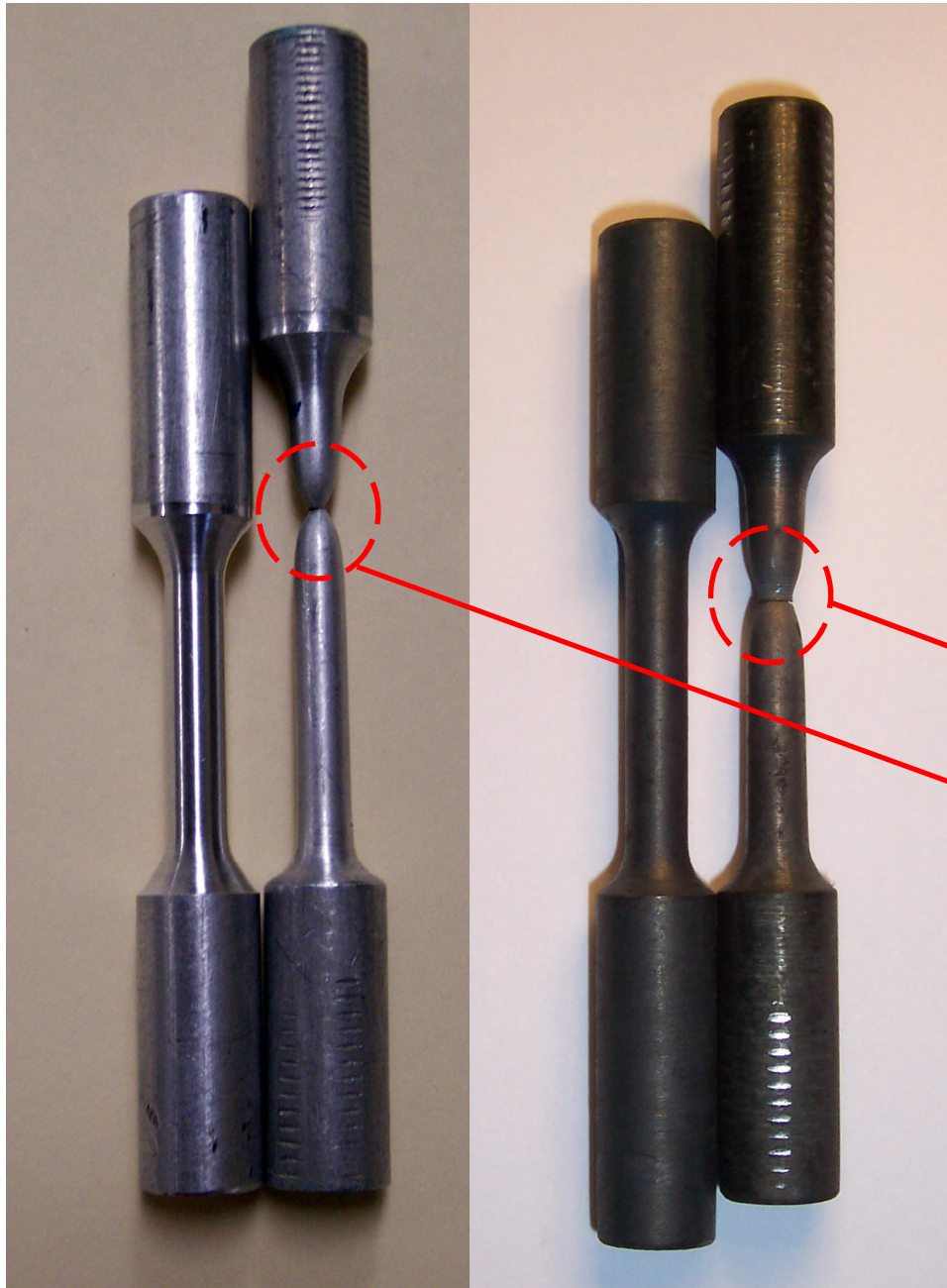


## Plastic (residual, permanent) deformation



**FIGURA 6.11**  
 Tipica curva  
 sforzo–deformazione fino  
 a frattura (punto  $F$ ). Il  
 carico di rottura è indica-  
 to dalla lettera  $M$ . Nei  
 riquadri circolari sono  
 rappresentate le varia-  
 zioni della geometria del  
 provino in punti differenti  
 della curva.

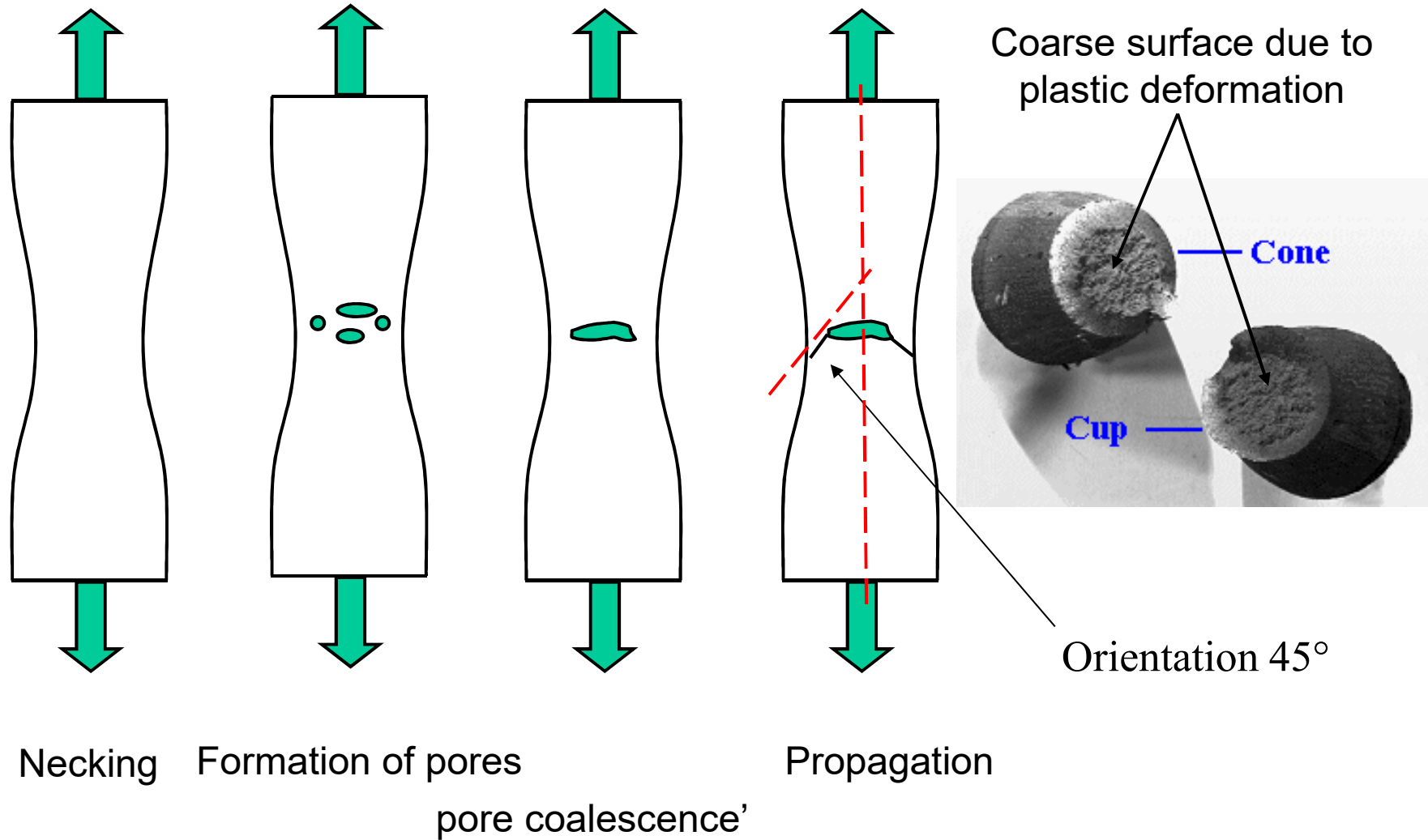




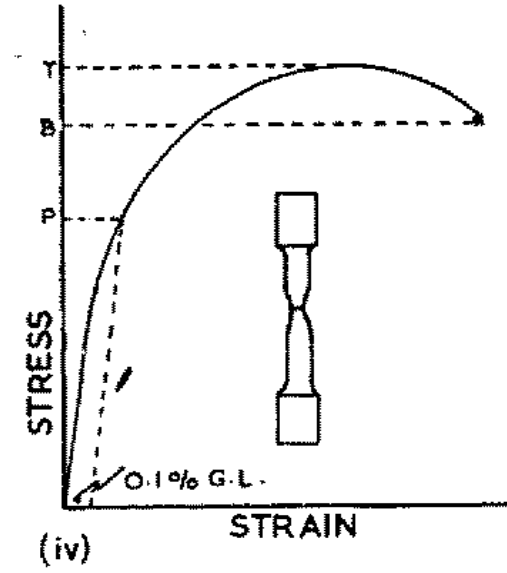
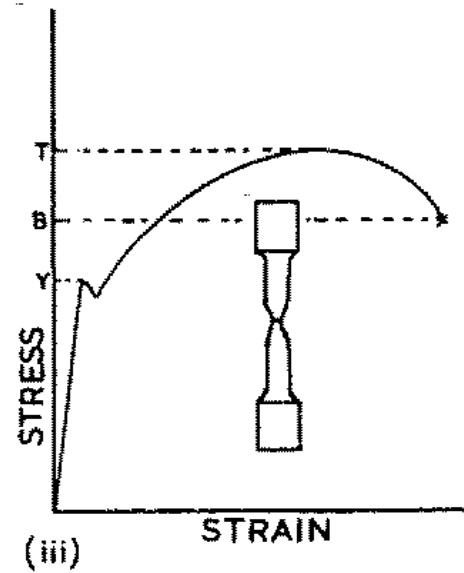
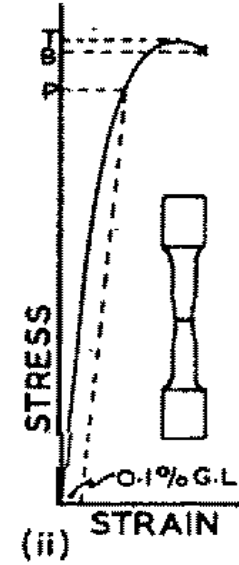
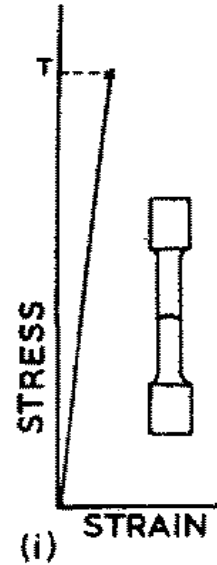
Metal specimens of steel (left) and bronze (right) before and after the test

**NECKING:**  
reduction of the  
resistant section  
(lateral contraction)  
due to a  
rearrangements of the  
material structure

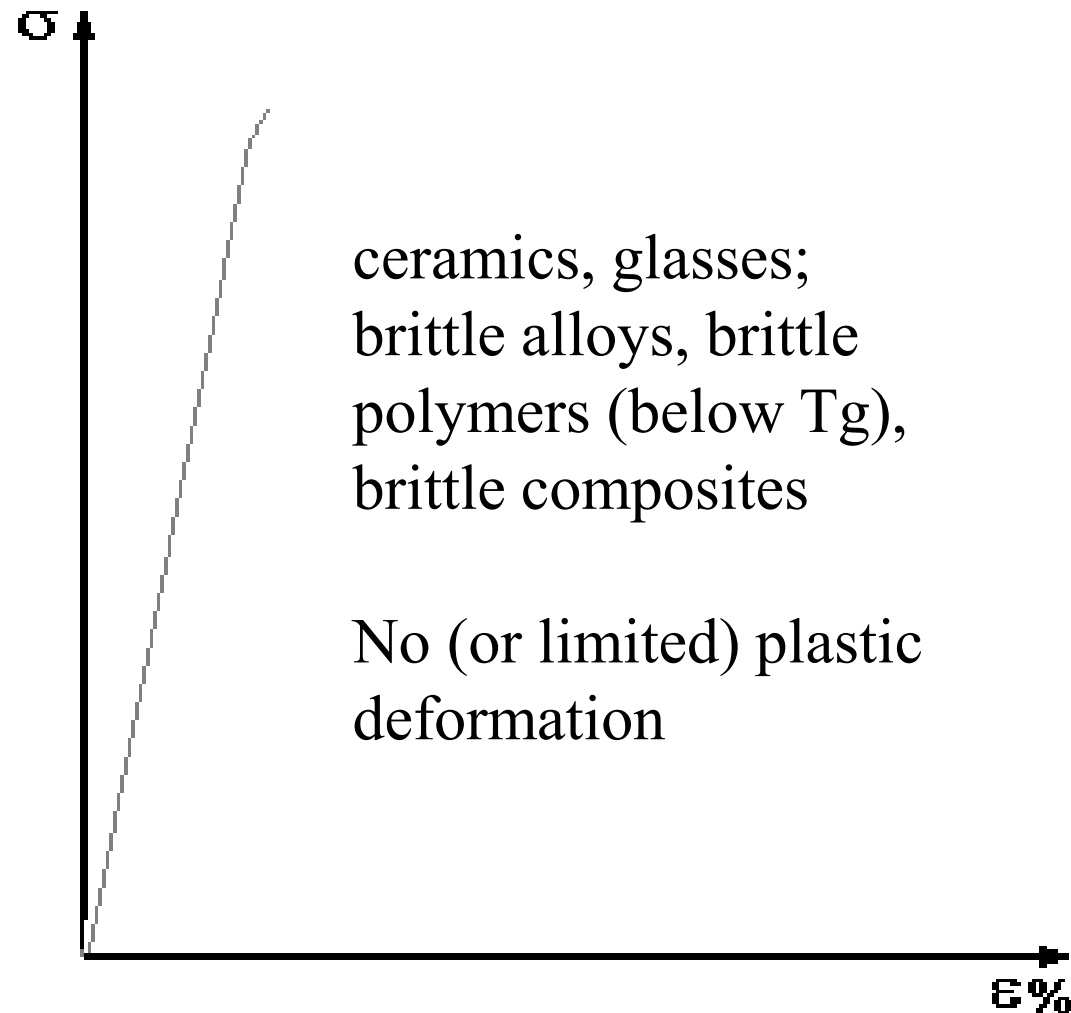
# Ductile fracture



## Tensile strength behaviour for different materials

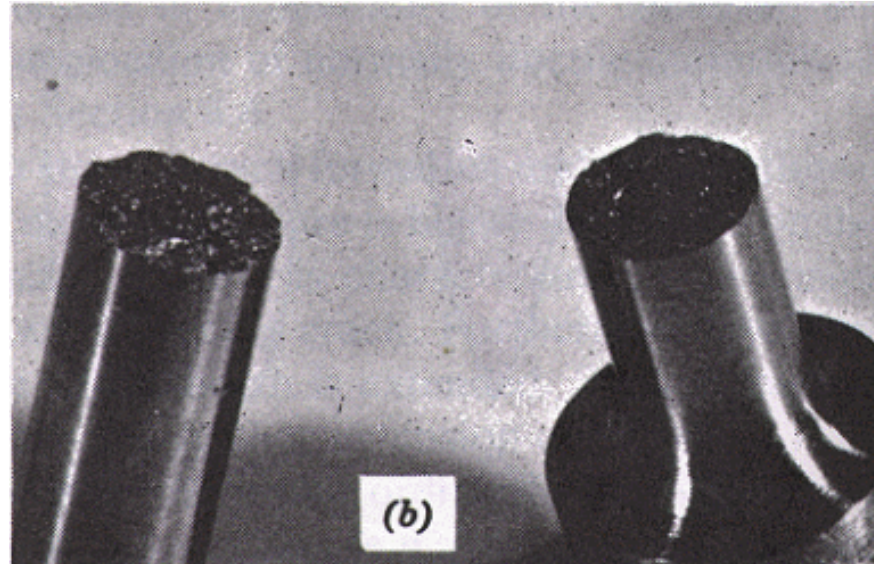


# Stress-strain curves for brittle materials



# Brittle fracture

- Without plastic deformation
  - Flat fracture surfaces

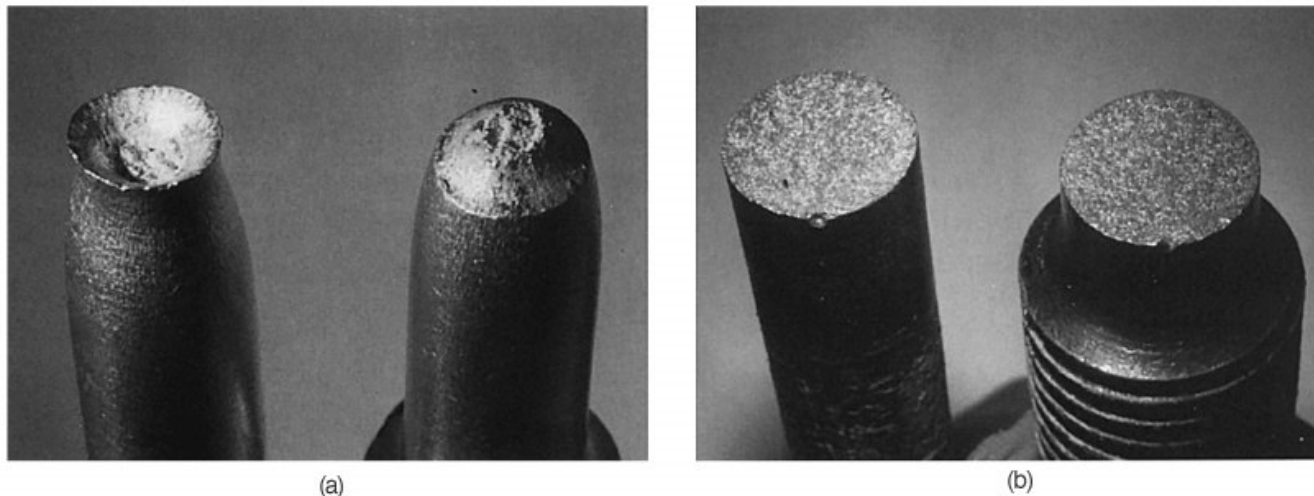


- Along crystalline planes for mono-crystalline materials (cleavage)
- Intergranular fracture for poly-crystalline materials



# Ductile and brittle fracture surfaces

- Ductile fracture: plastic deformation at the crack edge, slow crack propagation
- Brittle fracture: no plastic deformation at the crack edge, quick crack propagation (catastrophic failure)



**FIGURA 8.3** (a) Frattura coppa e cono nell'alluminio. (b) Frattura fragile in un acciaio dolce.



# Tensile strength ( $\sigma$ ) and % $\epsilon$ deformation at fracture

| • <b>Material</b>               | <b><math>\sigma</math> (MPa)</b> | <b><math>\epsilon</math> (%)</b> |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| • steel                         | 400-2500                         | 40-12                            |
| • Al alloys                     | 300-770                          | 8-16                             |
| • $\text{Al}_2\text{O}_3$ sint. | 200-340                          | negligible                       |
| • $\text{SiO}_2$ glass          | 110                              | negligible                       |
| • $\text{ZrO}_2$ sint.          | 80                               | negligible                       |
| • Polyesters                    | 40-80                            | 1-2                              |
| • Nylon                         | 70-160                           | 50-200                           |
| • Epoxy                         | 30-120                           | 3-6                              |

# How to modify plastic properties of materials

- Make dislocation motion more difficult = increase materials mechanical strength (and hardness)
- Grain size
- Solid solutions
- Precipitates and second phases
- Work hardening
- Perfect crystals/monocrystals

# Grain size reduction

$$\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$$

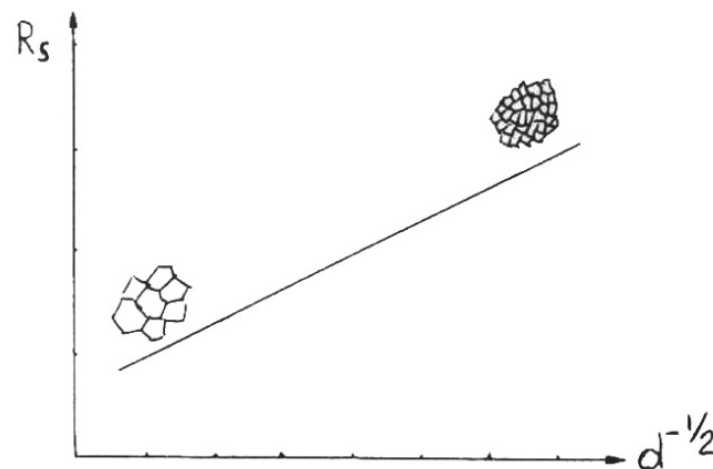
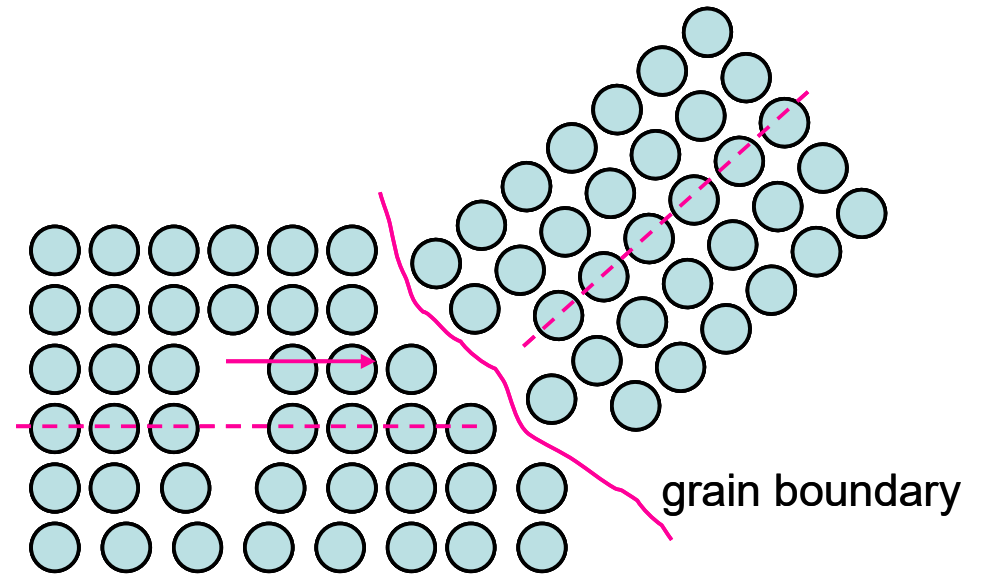
## Hall-Petch law

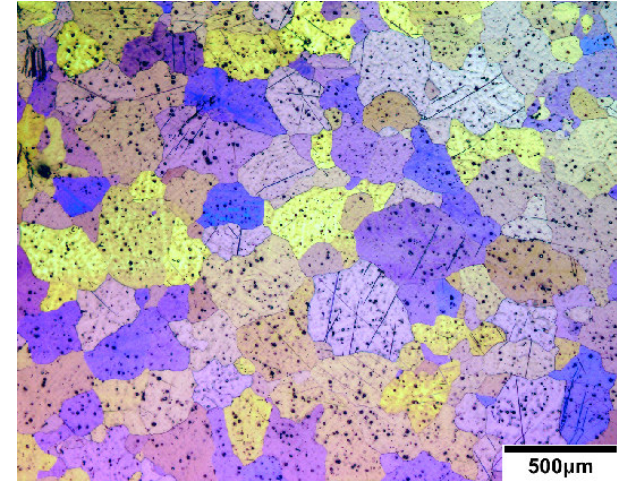
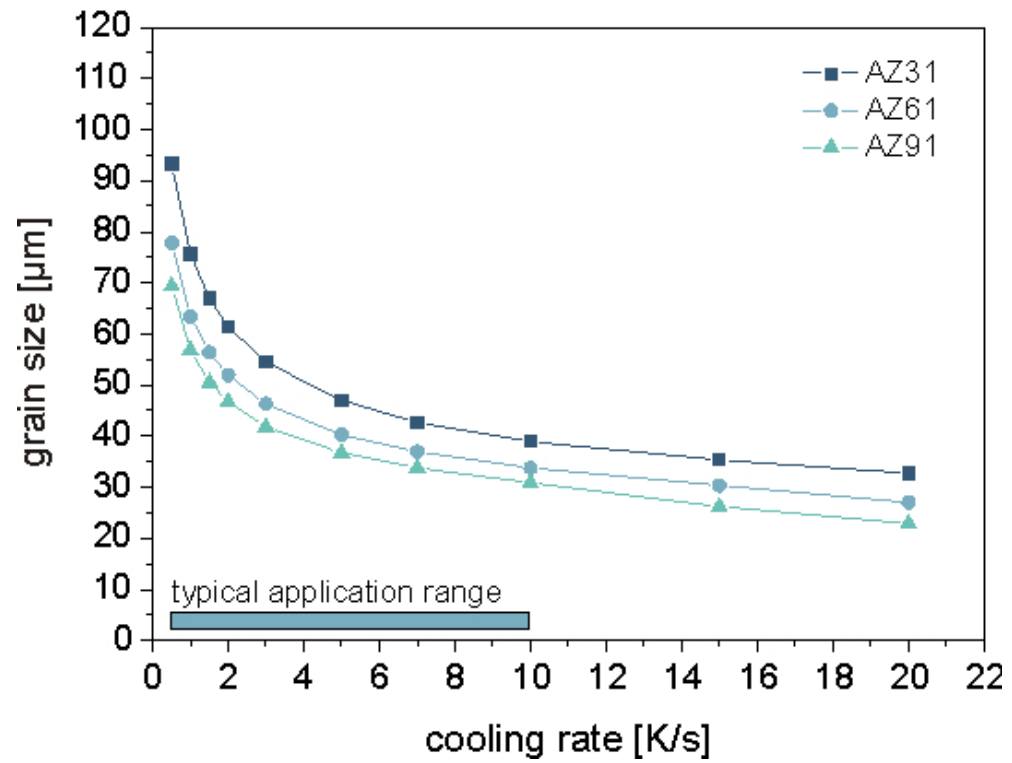
$d$  = grain diameter (avg)

$\sigma_y$  = yield strength

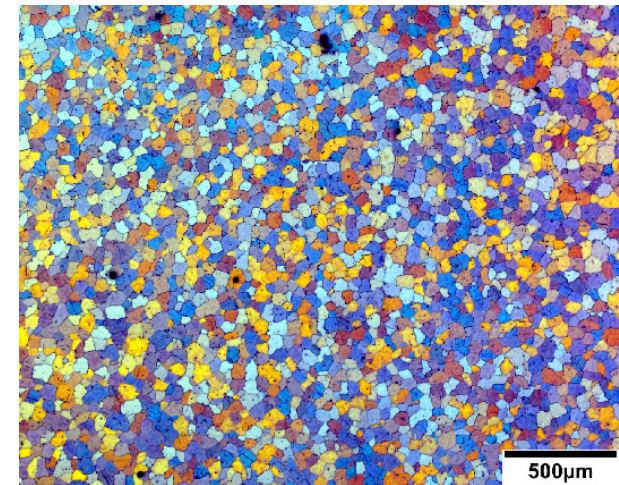
Materials related constant

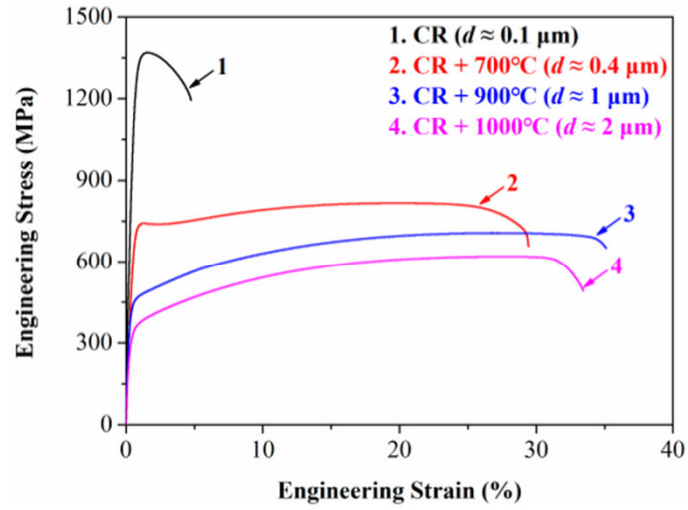
Grain size can be modified by  
thermal treatment



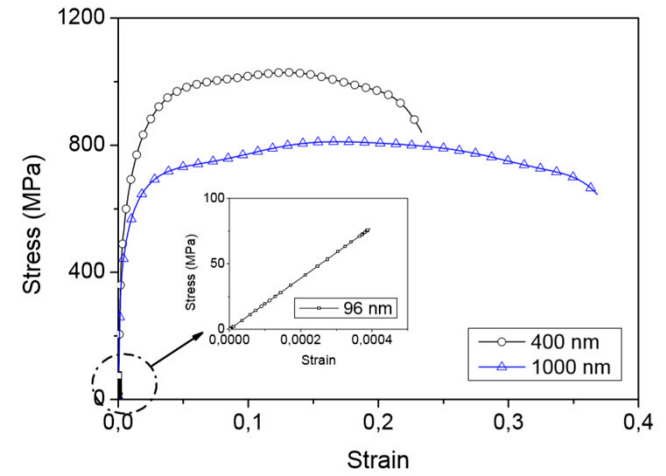


Need for nucleating agents  
(fine ceramic powders in the melt)

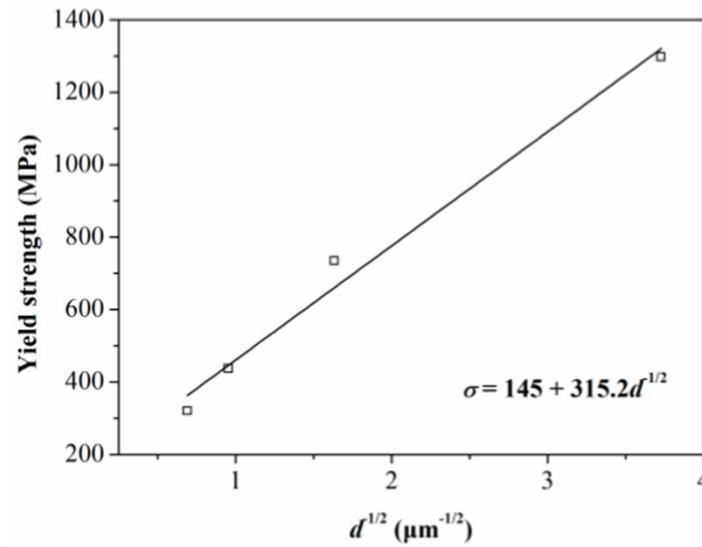




**Figure 4.** Engineering stress-strain curves of samples with different grain size



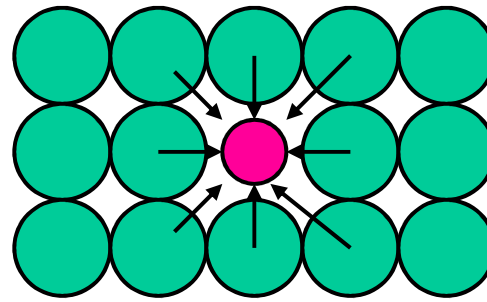
**Fig. 5.** Tensile stress-strain curves for the different grain sizes studied



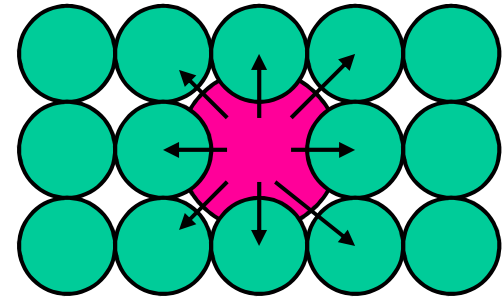
**Figure 8.** Yield strength vs. the inverse square root of grain size.

# Solid solutions

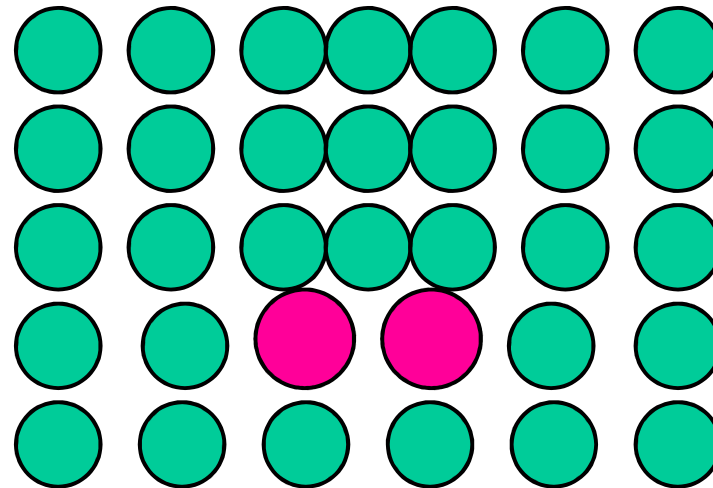
- Metallic solid solutions (alloys) have superior mechanical strength than pure metals



Tensile stresses

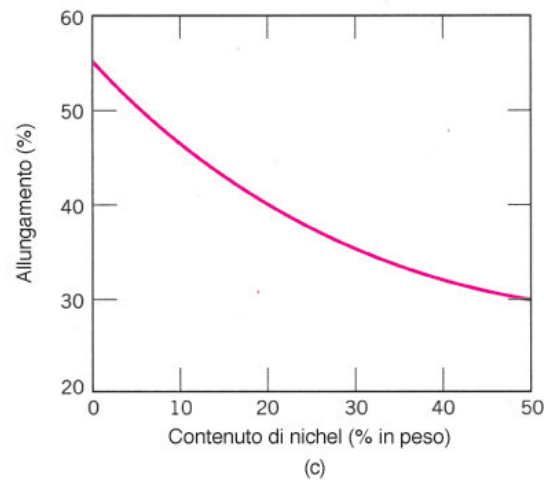
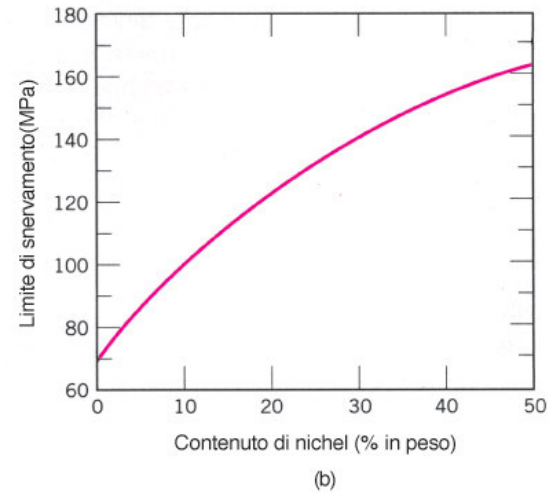
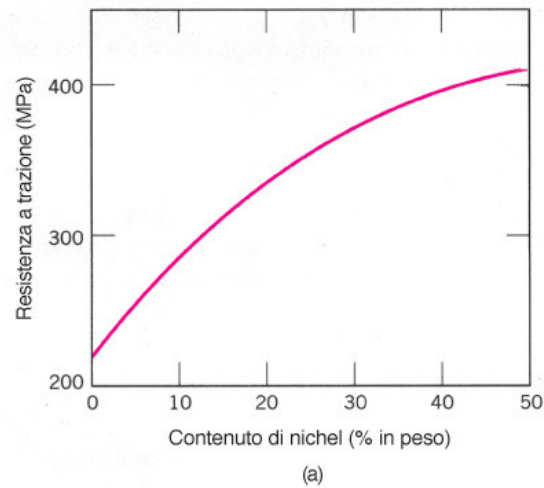


Compression stresses



Dislocations motion slowed

# Role of alloying elements on mechanical properties

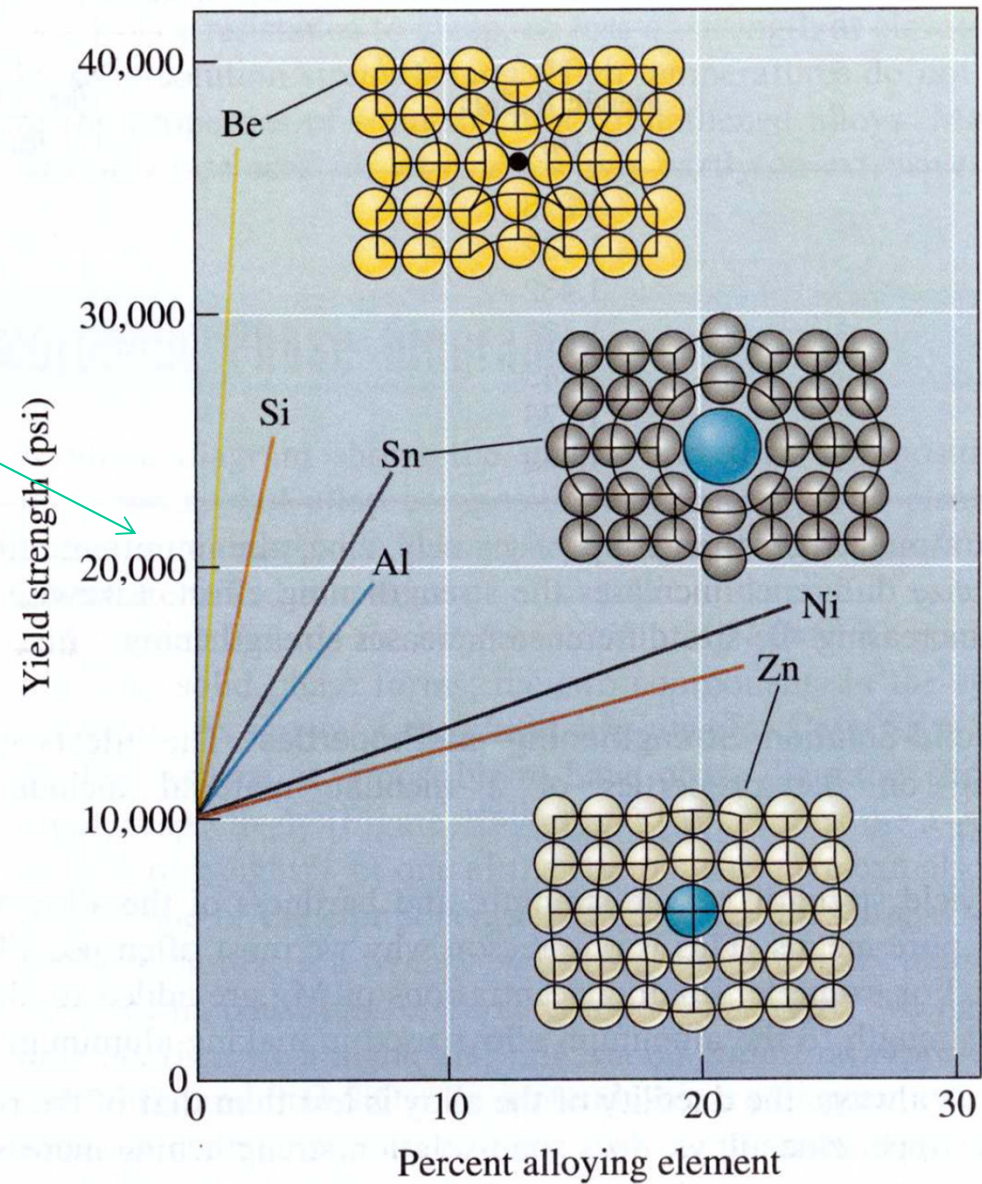


**FIGURA 7.16** Variazione con il contenuto di nichel del (a) carico di rottura a trazione, (b) limite di snervamento e (c) duttilità (A%) di una lega rame-nichel.



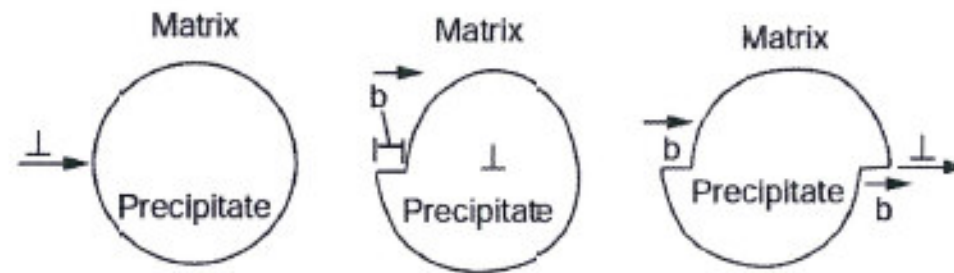
1 MPa = 145 psi; 20000  
psi = 137.9 MPa

The efficacy in increasing the  
yield strength is related to the  
solute/solvent size ratio

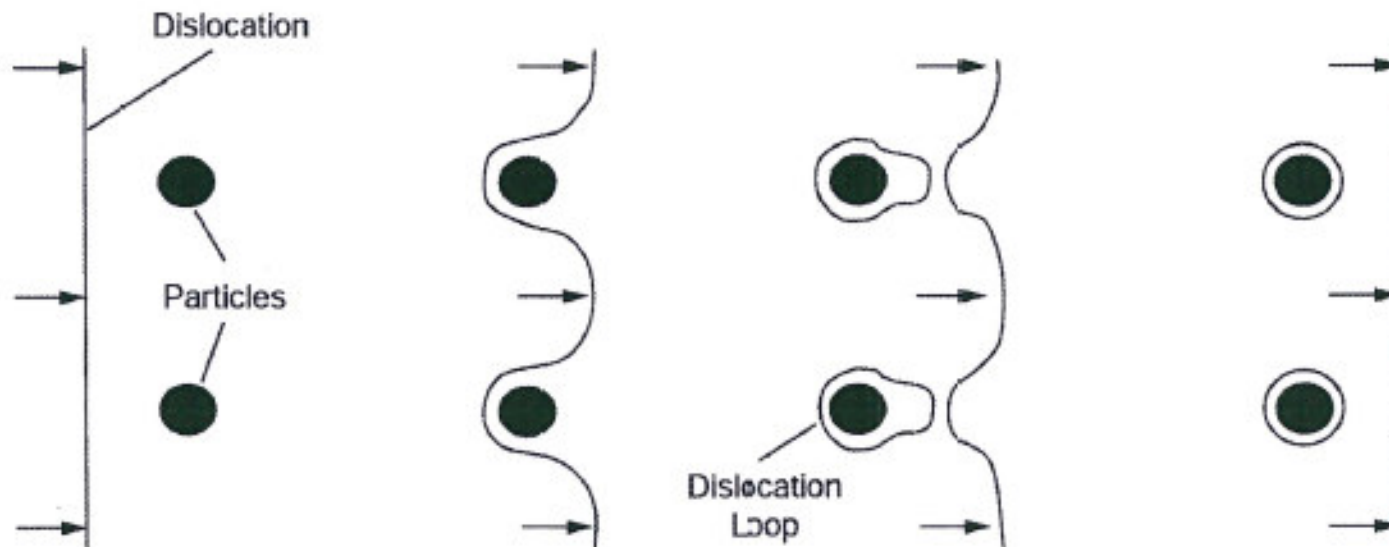




# Second phases

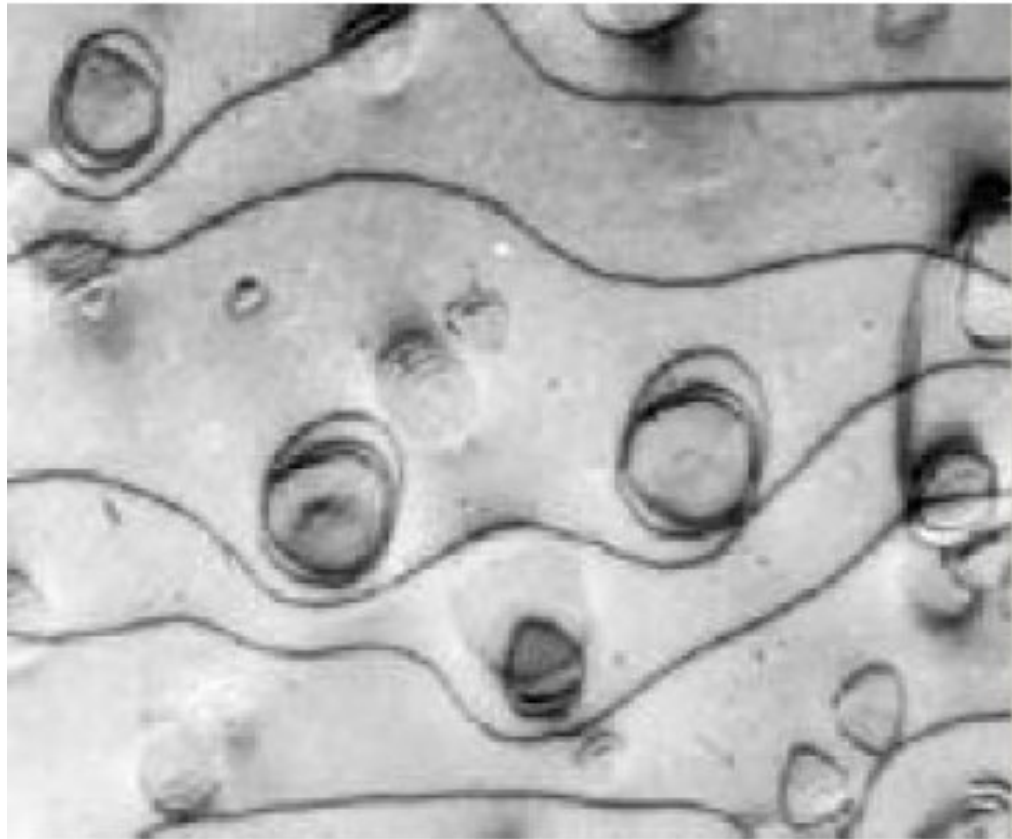


Dislocation Shearing Through Particle



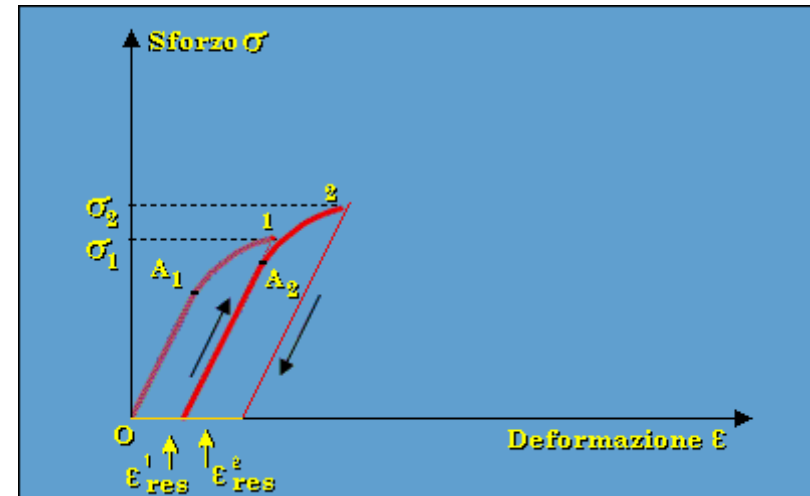
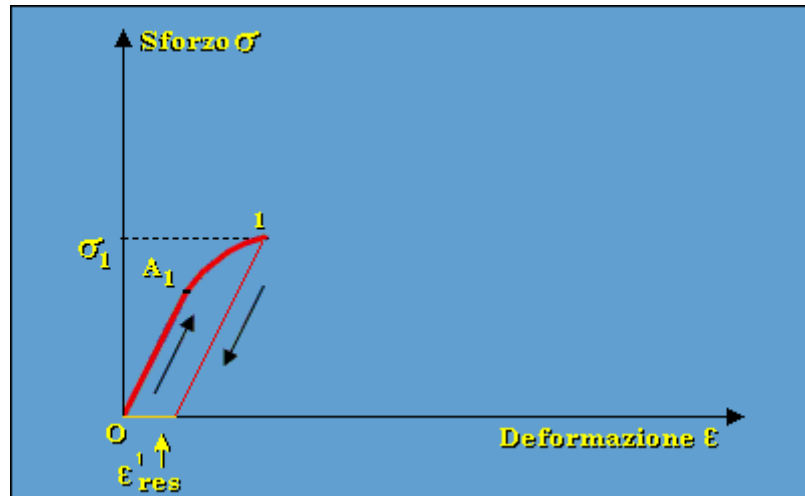
Dislocation Looping Around Particles

Orowan mechanism → ring dislocation around rigid inclusions

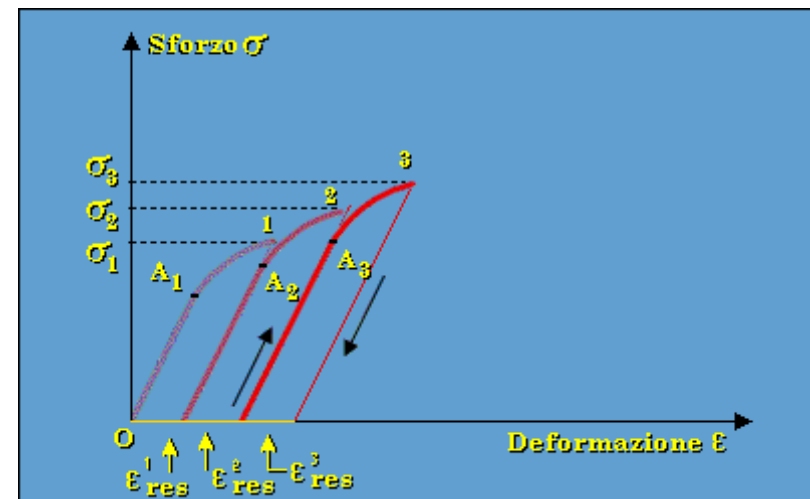


The efficacy of the mechanism is related to the number of particles rather than the total mass of particles.

# Work hardening



**Dislocation density:** little-deformed metals:  $10^6 \text{ cm/cm}^3$  ( $10,000 \text{ m/cm}^3$ ); highly-deformed metals:  $10^{12} \text{ cm/cm}^3$  ( $10,000,000 \text{ km/cm}^3$ )



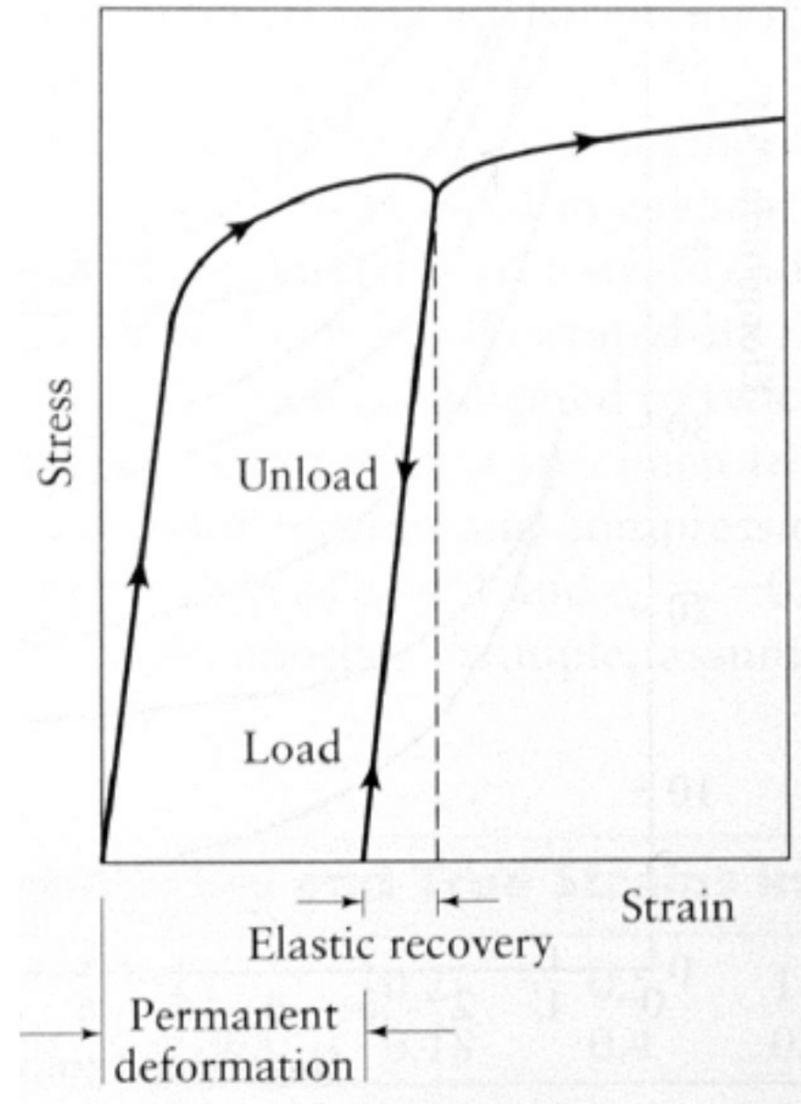
The material undergoes **successive loading-unloading cycles** (“cold working”) → formation of new dislocations → **accumulation of dislocations** → barrier to further deformation → **strengthening** of the material → increase of  $\sigma_y$  (and hardness).<sup>67</sup>

Ramberg-Osgood law  
(plastic field):

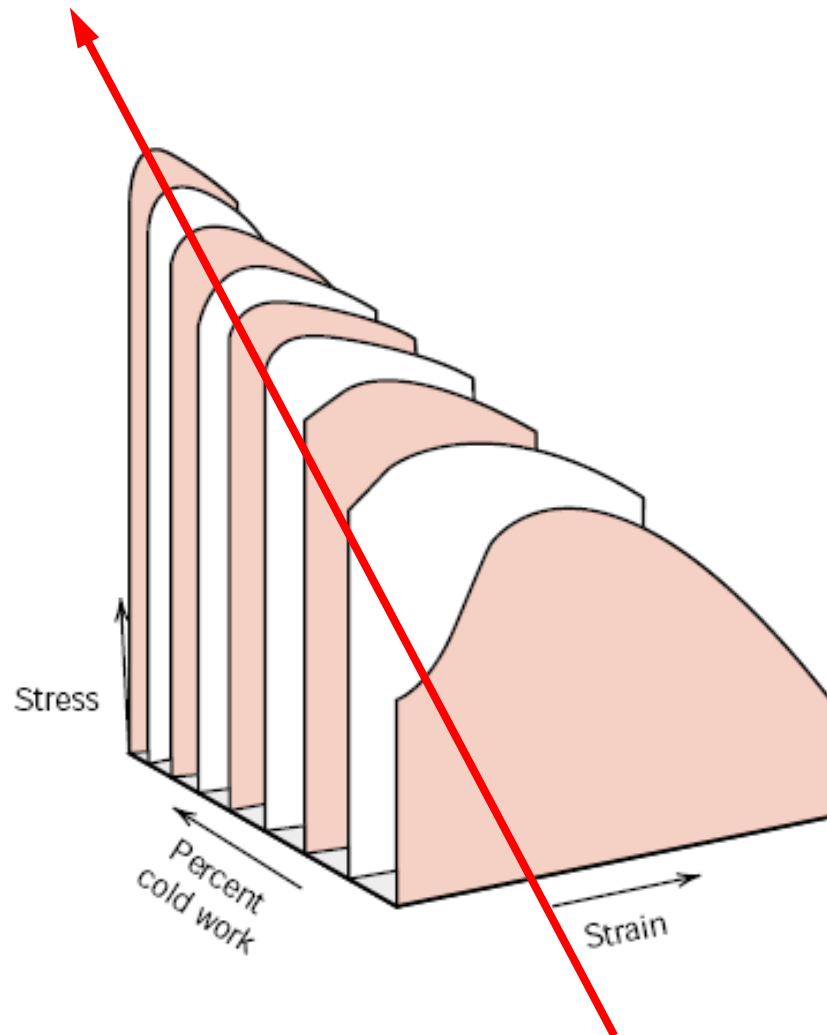
$$\sigma = H \times \epsilon^n$$

H and n = constant

n is called work-hardening exponent



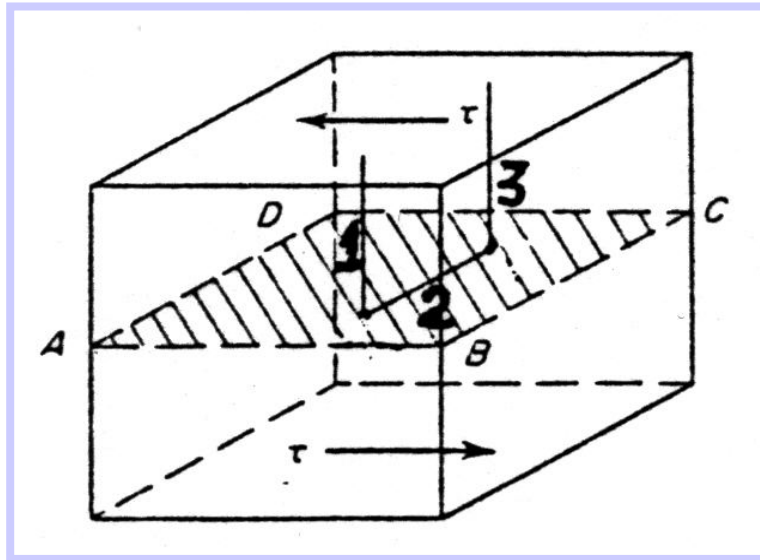
# COLD WORKING OF STEELS



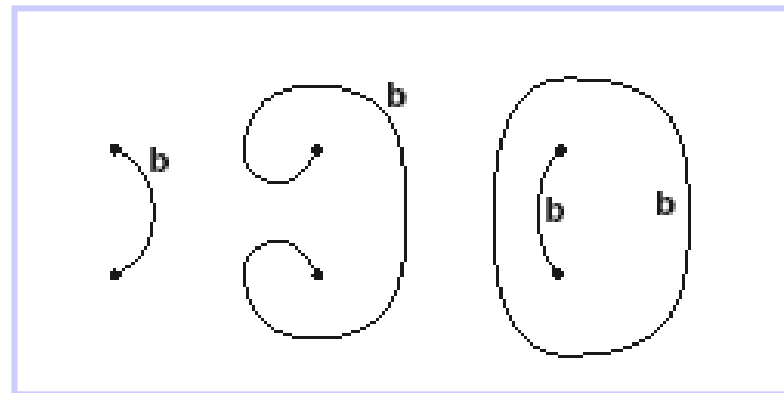
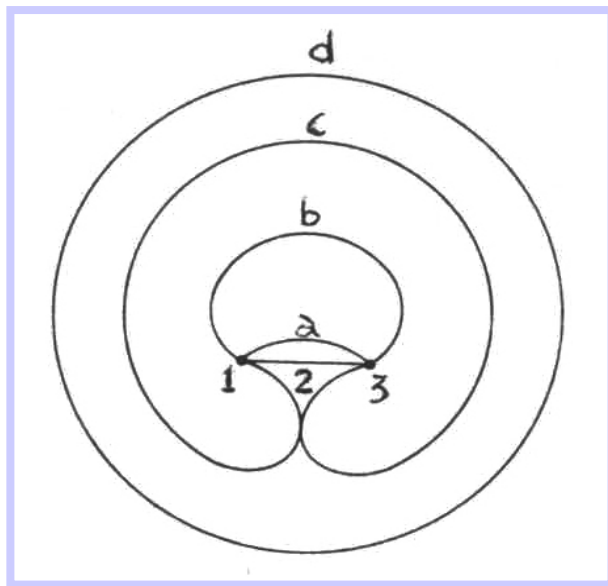
**FIGURE 8.20** The influence of cold work on the stress-strain behavior for a low-carbon steel. (From *Metals Handbook: Properties and Selection: Irons and Steels*, Vol. 1, 9th edition, B. Bardes, Editor, American Society for Metals, 1978, p. 221.)

- REVERSIBLE PROCESS:
- COLD WORKING/ANNEALING

Increase of  $\sigma_y$

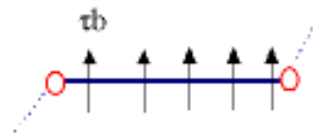


Mechanism of multiplication of dislocations («forest»)

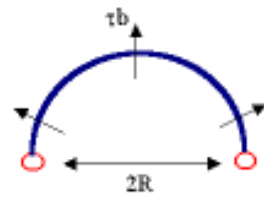


Frank-Read mechanism

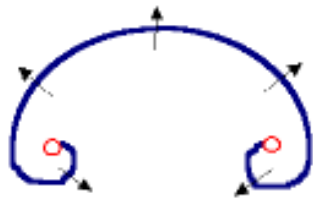
(1)



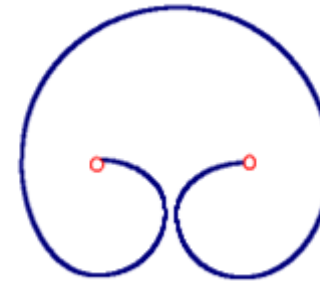
(2)



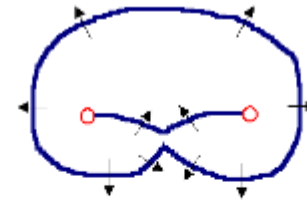
(3)



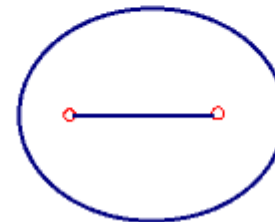
(4)



(5)

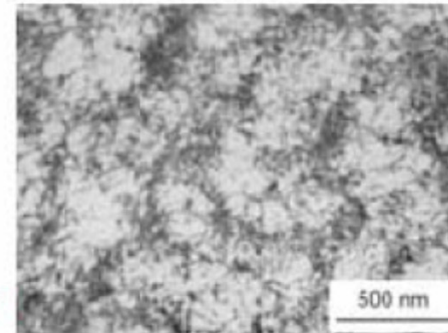
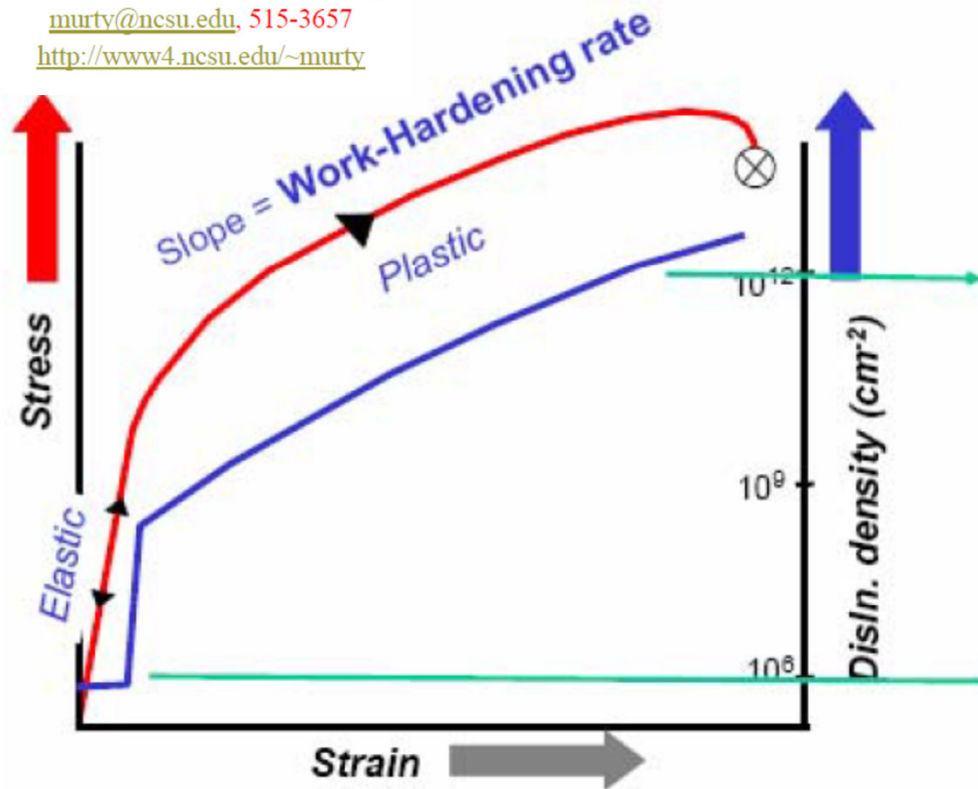


(6)

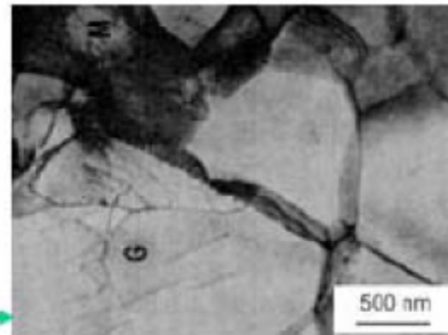


# Work-hardening on metals and alloys

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iron  
 $\epsilon = 20\%$



$\epsilon = 0\%$

Most dislocations are not mobile –  
they are just obstacles to the few that are.

$$\text{stress} \propto \frac{1}{\text{disln. spacing}} = \sqrt{(\text{disln. density})}$$



<https://www.tec-science.com/material-science/ductility-of-metals/fundamentals-of-deformation/>

1. Visualize different mechanism of hardening in stress-strain curves:

<https://www.tec-science.com/material-science/ductility-of-metals/deformation-process-in-real-crystal-structures/>

1. Visualize difference between Elastic deformation and plastic deformation:

<https://www.tec-science.com/material-science/ductility-of-metals/deformation-process-in-real-crystal-structures/>